

# BMC-K4510

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## USER'S AND PROGRAMMER'S GUIDE

a fantasy 8/16-bit computer

Draft version: alpha-0.2+108 · CPU 45GS10 · VICKY · 4 reSIDs · 256 MB RAM

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# **Part I**

# **User's Guide**

## Chapter 1

# The Machine

The BMC-K4510 is a fantasy computer: a machine that never existed, built the way 1985 might have built it with no budget committee in the room. It is not an emulation of any real computer. Its CPU, video chip, sound, and operating software are its own; the parts it borrows — a 6502-family instruction set, the SID sound chip — it borrows openly and then outgrows.

### 1.1 What is in the box

- **CPU: the 45GS10** — the MEGA65's 45GS02 instruction set (a 4510 with the Q pseudo-register and 32-bit flat addressing) plus this machine's own memory management: bank registers, a far-call gate, and RAM under the ROM. It runs at 40.5 MHz.
- **Memory: 256 MB**, flat, 28-bit. The CPU sees 64 KB at a time; everything else is one instruction away.
- **Video: VICKY** — 640×480, 256 colours from a 24-bit palette, four layers, 128 sprites, a blitter that draws lines and filled triangles, and a display-list coprocessor named SHEILA. Smaller modes (640×240, 320×240, 320×200, 160×200) are drawn into the same glass, doubled and centred, so the raster is always 480 lines however few of them the picture uses.
- **Sound: four SID chips** (reSID 6581) and a floating-point MATH unit the BASIC leans on.
- **A system ROM**: a shell with directories, a Wozmon-style monitor, and EhBASIC 2.22 extended with graphics and sound — with three more languages one word away: BBC BASIC on the Tube, Forth, and CP/M.



## 1.2 Getting one

On the **desktop** (Linux), three lines build the whole machine:

```
git clone https://github.com/mlongval/bmc-k4510
cd bmc-k4510 && ./setup.sh
./k4510
```

setup.sh installs the compilers and SDL2, builds everything, and runs the machine's ten test suites.

On the **Raspberry Pi 3B+**, download the SD-card zip from the project's releases page and put it on a card — either unzip it onto the card's root yourself, or let the script do it:

```
./install-sd.sh bmc-k4510-pi3.zip /media/you/CARD
```

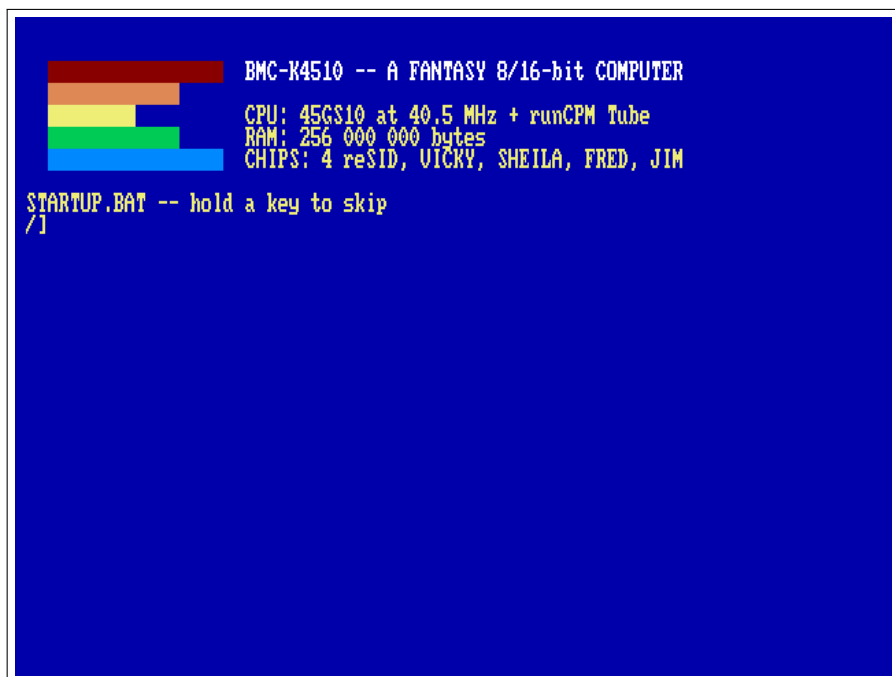
**Use an SDHC card — 4 to 32 GB, specifically.** SDHC ships FAT32 from the factory and just works. Older plain SD cards (2 GB and under) do *not* boot — we tested. Bigger SDXC cards (64 GB+) ship exFAT and will not boot until reformatted; ./install-sd.sh zip /dev/sdX --format does that (and erases the card). The machine needs about 5 MB, so the smallest SDHC card sold is plenty.

## 1.3 First boot

Switch it on (on the desktop: ./k4510; on the Raspberry Pi 3B+: insert the card and power up). The machine greets you in yellow on blue:

The [/] at the bottom is the shell prompt — the / is the directory you are in. Type HELP for the commands, INFO for the machine's full self-description, and DIR to see your files.

**Keys on the desktop:** Escape is RUN/STOP (stops a BASIC program), Ctrl-C is STOP, Shift+Escape quits the emulator. Reset is a chord, the way it was Commodore+Restore on the C64: Super+PageUp (the Windows or Command key and PageUp) — one



The boot screen: five stepped colour bars, then the machine, its CPU and Tube, its memory and its chips. Everything else is one INFO away, and LOGO prints this again.

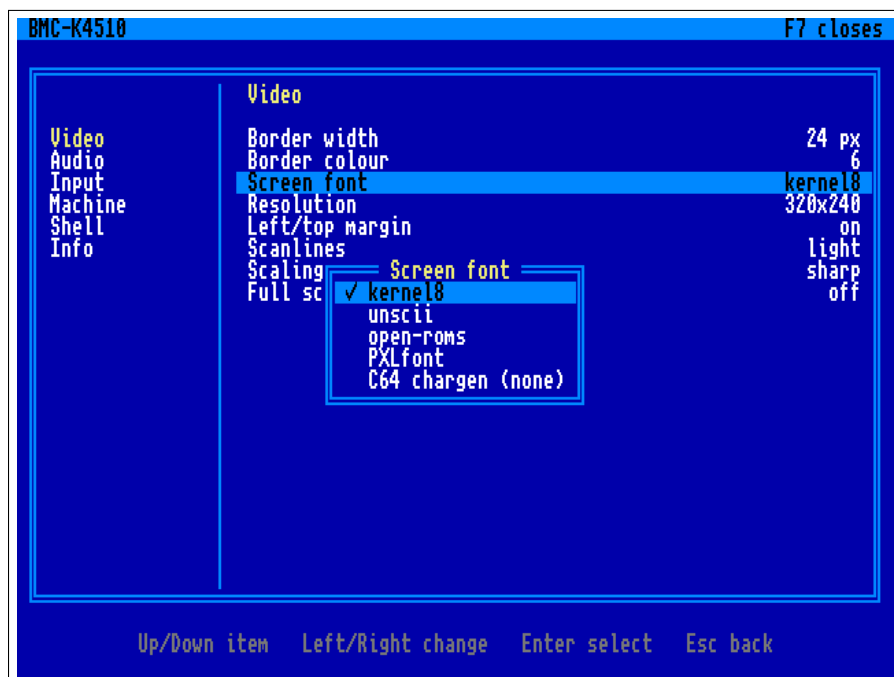
key cannot do it by accident. F7 opens the menu.

## 1.4 The F7 menu

F7 (unshifted; Shift+F7 still reaches BBC BASIC) freezes the machine and takes the whole screen, in the manner of the C64 Ultimate's: the categories down the left, the settings of the chosen one on the right, and a line at the foot saying what the keys do in whichever pane holds the cursor. Sound stops, and closing the menu resumes exactly where it froze — the machine is not disturbed, only hidden. The menu draws with its own font and never touches the machine's memory, so it opens even when a program has wrecked the screen, and being opaque it reads the

same whatever was there.

Up and Down move; Enter or Right crosses from the categories to the settings; Left and Right step a value; Escape goes back a pane, and closes at the categories; F7 closes from anywhere. A setting with a list of choices opens that list over the panes, and *applies as the cursor passes each one* — the screen font swaps under the menu so you can see it — with Escape putting back whatever was there when the list opened.



The F7 menu: categories on the left, the Video page on the right, the screen-font list open over them.

**Video** border width and colour around the picture; the screen font (*kernel8*, *unscii*, *open-roms*, *PXLfont* — a live swap of the chargen at \$010000, the two PETSCII fonts rearranged into ASCII order, and *C64 chargen* if you have put a Commodore character ROM in /SYSTEM/chargen.bin — the entry says so when you have not); *scanlines*, a dark line between each of the machine's, in three strengths — the picture is drawn at twice the height and every second row

dimmed, so it is exact rather than an overlay, and it costs about a third of a millisecond a frame; *scaling*, which is how the picture is fitted to the window: *sharp* (hard pixels, any window size — so at a size that is not a whole multiple some pixel rows are wider than others), *soft* (smoothed), or *sharp-fit* (hard pixels *and* a whole-number multiple, so every pixel of the machine is the same size on the glass and what does not divide becomes a black border); full screen.

The figures in this book are taken with the effects off, whatever the settings say, so that what you see here is the machine's own output.

**Audio** volume.

**Input** the reset chord (Super, Ctrl or Alt + PageUp, or Ctrl+Alt+Del); which key opens the menu (F7, F8, F11 or Pause).

**Machine** *save state* and *load state*, four slots each (the whole machine — CPU, every used page of the 256 MB, the banks and MAP, VICKY, the devices, JIM — to k4510-slotN.k4s beside the settings file; the row shows when the slot was written; the Tube co-processor is not in the file and is stopped by a load); *reset*; *power cycle* (memory cleared, ROM reloaded); *stop* the Tube co-processor; *quit*.

**Shell** whether an unknown word at the prompt may run a CP/M .COM from drive A: (Chapter 6). Off to begin with, on purpose: D typed for DIR should not start a Z80 program. It changes only the guess — a command that names CPM outright, an alias among them, works either way. This is the first setting the machine itself reads: the host puts the menu's switches in \$D521 and the ROM looks there.

**Info** version, ROM, files, host.

Leaving the menu writes the settings to k4510.cfg beside fs/ (on the Pi, SD:/k4510/k4510.cfg) — a plain key = value file you may edit; comments and keys it does not know are kept. Adding a setting is one row in core/ui/settings.c, one row in the menu tree in core/ui/menu.c, and

the place that reads it; the same code runs on the Pi, where the C64 keyboard's F7 opens it too.

## Chapter 2

# The Shell

The shell is what the machine boots into. It is a file manager, a program launcher and a front door to the monitor, and every command here also works from BASIC with a \* in front. Type HELP for the whole command set on one screen — the text it prints is itself a file on disk, a hidden one called /.HELP.

### 2.1 Files and directories

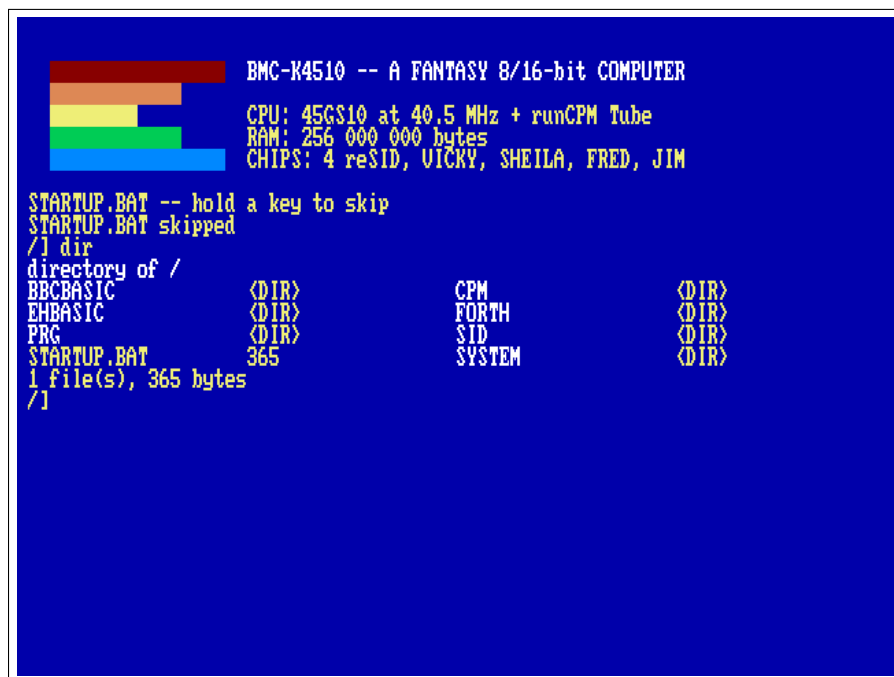
Files live on the host (the fs/ directory on the desktop, the k4510/fs/ folder of the SD card on the Pi). The layout is one directory per language: machine code in /PRG, the BASICs in /EHBASIC and /BBCBASIC, Forth in /FORTH, CP/M's drives under /CPM, music in /SID — and a bare name is searched across the language directories too, so you rarely need a path.

```
DIR          CD EHBASIC      CD ..
MKDIR MYDIR  RM OLD.TXT      RMDIR MYDIR
TYPE README.TXT RENAME OLD NEW CP FROM TO
LOAD name [addr] SAVE name from.to
XD name      a hex dump (HEX works too); Esc stops it
```

Names that begin with a dot are hidden; DIR A shows them. DIR also takes a directory to look in, or a pattern to match: DIR PRG lists that folder without going there, DIR \*.PAS and DIR ?.TXT match here (\* any run of characters, ? any one), and DIR A \*.BAS means both at once.

### 2.2 Running things

RUN balls.prg runs a program; so does RUN balls, and so does plain BALLS — an unknown word is tried as a program on disk before the shell gives up, *with its arguments*, the way REXX did it on the mainframes. A pro-



```

BMC-K4510 -- A FANTASY 8/16-bit COMPUTER
CPU: 45GS10 at 40.5 MHz + runCPM Tube
RAM: 256 000 000 bytes
CHIPS: 4 reSID, VICKY, SHEILA, FRED, JIM

STARTUP.BAT -- hold a key to skip
STARTUP.BAT skipped
/l dir
directory of /
BBCBASIC      <DIR>          CPM          <DIR>
EHBASIC       <DIR>          FORTH         <DIR>
PRG           <DIR>          SID           <DIR>
STARTUP.BAT   365          SYSTEM         <DIR>
1 file(s), 365 bytes
/l

```

DIR: directories first in white, then files with their sizes, two columns.

gram reads its arguments through the ARGV system call; SAY is the demonstration:

```
SAY HELLO FROM THE DISK
```

prints HELLO FROM THE DISK — there is no SAY command, only a say.prg in /PRG. Try SIDPLAY, the SID jukebox; EDIT and VI are the editors (Chapter 8); and four words open whole languages: EHBASIC (Chapter 3), BBC (Chapter 4), FORTH (Chapter 5) and CPM (Chapter 6).

## 2.3 SWAP: running one thing from inside another

A program is loaded where the last one was, so starting one from inside a BASIC would ordinarily flatten the program you were writing. SWAP command puts the caller away first — the whole of the CPU's memory, and the screen — runs the command on a clean machine, and gives

the caller back untouched:

```
*SWAP EDIT MYPROG.BAS
```

from EhBASIC edits a file and returns to your program, variables and screen as they were. One level deep; the thing being run must be an ordinary program, and a BASIC's far memory is not disturbed because nothing else touches it. BBC BASIC needs none of this: it lives on the co-processor, out of reach of anything running here.

## 2.4 Aliases

ALIAS gives a name to a line.

```
ALIAS          list them
ALIAS LL DIR A  define one
ALIAS LL       nothing after the name: remove it
```

Whatever you type after the alias is added to the end, so a definition takes arguments. Aliases are tried *last*, after every other rule, so one can never hide a real command: ALIAS DIR ECHO no is accepted and DIR still lists the directory. They live in memory — in a sideways bank, not in the 64 KB — so they survive a reset but not a power cycle, which is what /STARTUP.BAT is for.

## 2.5 The network

A URL is a file name. Anything the shell reads — TYPE, LOAD, CP, RUN, and the bare-word rule above — accepts `http://` or `https://` in place of a name, and the machine fetches it:

```
TYPE https://raw.githubusercontent.com/mlongval/bmc-k4510/master/README.md
CP http://example.org/game.prg game.prg
RUN http://example.org/game.prg
```

EhBASIC's LOAD and BBC BASIC's LOAD on the Tube take URLs the same way. The idea is the C64's Meatloaf cartridge, where a disk name



could be an address on the internet; here it costs the ROM nothing, because the ROM never looks at a name — the host does the fetching. A typed line is 95 characters, and so is the longest URL.

A `tnfs://` URL is more than a file: it is a place. TNFS is the little UDP file protocol the FujiNet and Meatloaf servers speak, and the machine's current directory can be on one of them:

```
CD tnfs://fujinet.online/  
DIR  
CD CBM  
DIR  
CD -
```

DIR lists the server, a bare name loads from it (so RUN, and the bareword rule, run programs straight off the internet), CD .. climbs, CD - comes home. The prompt shows where you are. The server is read-only from here.

For programs that want a live connection there is the *N: device* at \$D900 (FujiNet's name for it): four channels, each a URL opened for reading and writing — `tcp://host:port` for a connection, `http://` for a page. TELNET host port is the demonstration, a `telnet.prg` in /PRG: what you type goes out, what arrives is drawn by JIM, the terminal (Chapter 4), so a BBS gets its ANSI colours and CP437 art and the cursor and function keys go out as VT sequences; F12 hangs up (Escape belongs to the far end). The register map is in Chapter 10 and `core/net.h`. On the Pi the network is the Ethernet port (DHCP); without a cable the device answers “not fitted” and URLs are simply absent names. The Pi has no TLS, so `https://` works on the desktop only.

## 2.6 CAPSLOCK

CAPSLOCK toggles a caps-lock: while it is on, letters read from the keyboard come up uppercase, so a language whose keywords are uppercase — BBC BASIC, EhBASIC — needs no Shift held. Digits and symbols are untouched, so it is a caps lock and not a shift lock, and Shift gives you the *other* case while it is on, the way a caps lock has always worked. It is also suspended while a program is running, so a program

that wants lower case — :q in VI, say — gets it, and the lock comes back when the program does. CAPSLOCK ON and CAPSLOCK OFF set it explicitly. It works from inside a BASIC through the \* escape: \*CAPSLOCK in BBC BASIC or EhBASIC.

## 2.7 Scripts and the boot file

EXEC name runs a text file as shell commands, one per line. A line whose first character is # is a comment, and a blank line is ignored. At power-on the machine runs /STARTUP.BAT as such a script, if it exists. It says so while it waits — STARTUP.BAT -- hold a key to skip — and gives you half a second's grace; a key held or typed in that window skips it, says STARTUP.BAT skipped, and the keystroke is not lost. It is the place to put your aliases; /SYSTEM/STARTUP.SAMPLE is one to copy from.

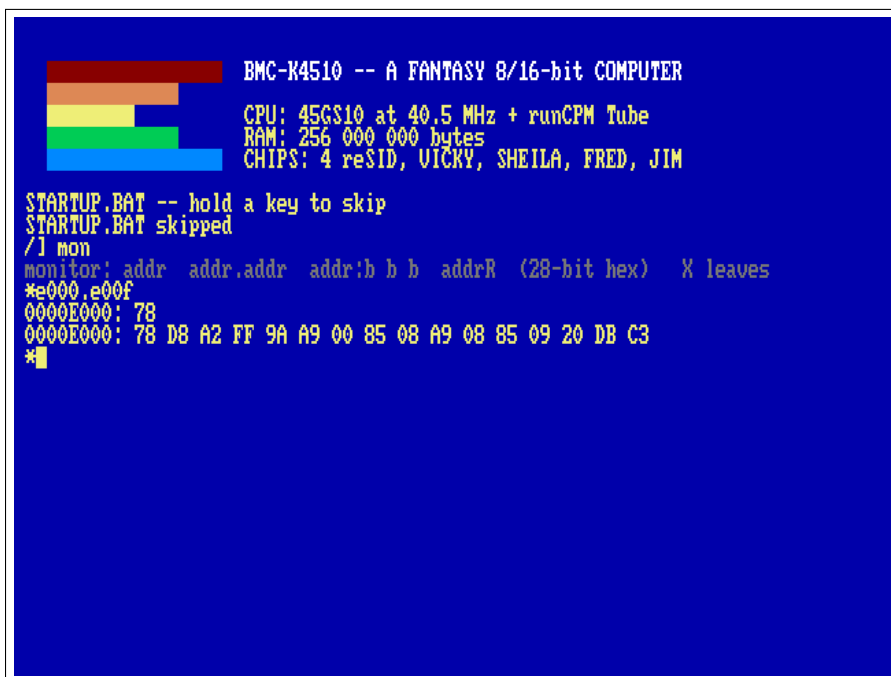
## 2.8 The monitor

MON (old-timers may type WOZ) opens the machine monitor at a \* prompt; its grammar is Wozmon's, with 28-bit addresses:

```
*E000.E00F      examine a range
*0300:A9 41 60   store bytes
*0300R          run from $0300
*X              leave
```

## 2.9 Housekeeping

INFO is the machine's self-description; TIME the clock; MODE and COLOR set the text screen — CLS clears it and CLG clears the bitmap over it, whoever drew it — both reach a BASIC through the \* escape, which is how you tidy up after a demo that left its picture behind; FILL and COPY work on memory; HUSH silences all four SIDs at once; LS is DIR for fingers that have used Unix too long. LOGO clears the screen and prints the startup banner again — the colour bars and the machine's own description — which is



```
BMC-K4510 -- A FANTASY 8/16-bit COMPUTER
CPU: 45GS10 at 40.5 MHz + runCPM Tube
RAM: 256 000 000 bytes
CHIPS: 4 reSID, VICKY, SHEILA, FRED, JIM

STARTUP.BAT -- hold a key to skip
STARTUP.BAT skipped
/! mon
monitor: addr addr.addr addr:b b b addrR (28-bit hex) X leaves
*e000.e00f
0000E000: 78
0000E000: 78 D8 A2 FF 9A A9 00 85 08 A9 08 85 09 20 DB C3
*█
```

The monitor examining the ROM. MON E000.E00F runs one line without entering the prompt.

a tidy way to end a session or start a screenshot. RESET restarts the machine from the shell, the same cold start the reset chord performs.

Several commands answer to more than one name, so that habits from another machine mostly work: CD is also CHDIR, RM is DEL and ERASE, REN is RENAME and MV, DIR is LS, COLOR is COLOUR, XD is HEX, BBCBASIC is BBC, and CAPSLOCK is CAPS. CP and COPY are *not* the same command: CP copies a file, COPY copies memory.

MODE on its own says where you are; MODE n moves. The second number is the margin: 1 (the default) keeps a one-cell gap at the top and the left, 0 uses every cell.

| MODE | pixels  | text  |                         |
|------|---------|-------|-------------------------|
| 0    | 640×480 | 80×60 | the whole glass         |
| 1    | 640×240 | 80×30 | the machine starts here |
| 2    | 320×240 | 40×30 |                         |
| 3    | 320×200 | 40×25 | the C64's geometry      |
| 4    | 160×200 | 20×25 | four screen pixels each |

The F7 menu, under Video, has the same two knobs: *Resolution* shows what the machine is actually in — it follows a MODE you type — and choosing another asks the ROM to perform it, because the console's geometry belongs to the ROM and not to the host. *Left/top margin* is the second parameter.

The menu offers only the first three. MODE 3 and MODE 4 are for a game or a language that wants the pixels: 40×25 and 20×25 are not a shell, and a machine you have steered into 20 columns from a menu is a machine you then have to steer out of. They are a MODE command away, the menu shows one when you are in it, and neither is ever written to k4510.cfg — what is saved is never smaller than 320×240.

The picture is always painted into 640×480: a 200-line mode gets 40 blank lines above and below it, and a 320- or 160-wide one has its pixels doubled or quadrupled sideways. Raster lines and SHEILA's display list count the glass, 0–479, not the mode — so in MODE 3 the first line of your picture is raster line 40.

## 2.10 When STARTUP.BAT is the problem

/STARTUP.BAT runs at power-on, and a bad one runs at every power-on. The machine says so at the banner:

```
STARTUP.BAT -- hold a key to skip
```

and gives you half a second. Hold any key and it says STARTUP.BAT skipped instead of running it. If that moment is hard to catch, switch it off in the F7 menu under Shell: *Run STARTUP.BAT*. That setting is the host's, kept in k4510.cfg, so it survives a power cycle and no wedged program in the machine can take it away from you. Boot clean, fix the file, switch it back on.

On the desktop there is a third way, for one boot only:

```
./k4510 --no-startup.bat
```

(`--no-startup` does the same, as does `K4510_NO_STARTUP=1` in the environment). It skips `/STARTUP.BAT` for that run and touches nothing: the `F7` setting and `k4510.cfg` are left exactly as they were. That is the one to reach for in a script, or when a startup file has wedged the machine and you want a single clean boot to go and fix it.

## 2.11 When something goes wrong

`DUMP` a note writes the whole machine state — registers, screen, the last 4096 instructions, your last keystrokes — to a numbered file on the host, for a human (or their AI) to read later. `DUMP ON` does it automatically every fifteen seconds.

## Chapter 3

# EhBASIC

The machine speaks EhBASIC 2.22 — Lee Davison's Enhanced BASIC — with this machine's additions: graphics statements that ride the blitter, sound on four SIDs, floating point on the MATH unit, and an escape hatch to the shell.

```
RUN EHBASIC
```

It comes up ready: the banner, 47103 Bytes free — more than twenty-one C64s more than a C64 — and a Ready prompt — the traditional Memory size ? question is gone; the machine knows.

### 3.1 Ten minutes of it

```
RUN "DEMOS.BAS"
```

The menu chains: RUN "name" (or LOAD inside a running program) loads another BASIC program and runs it — that is how one BASIC program hands over to another, exactly as on a C64.

### 3.2 The machine's own statements

```
GRAPHICS 2          640x480 bitmap over the text
PLOT X,Y,C          LINE X1,Y1,X2,Y2,C
TRI X1,Y1,X2,Y2,X3,Y3,C
PALETTE I,R,G,B     GCLS          GRAPHICS 0
```

Colours 0–15 belong to the text screen; demos use 16 and up. GRAPHICS 0 puts the text mode and its palette back, whatever the program changed.

```

BMC-K4510  EHBASIC DEMOS

1  LINES      SPINNING LINES (BLITTER LINE OP)
2  TRIS       300 RANDOM TRIANGLES
3  SINE       SINE WAVES (MATH UNIT)
4  STARS      A STARFIELD (ANY KEY LEAVES)
5  README     HOW TO USE EHBASIC HERE
6  SIDWAVE    ONE SID VOICE, FOUR WAVEFORMS
7  SIDBEAT    BASS ON SID0, DRUMS ON SID1
8  SIDFILT    THE FILTER: A CHORD THROUGH A SWEEP
9  SID6       TWO SIDS, SIX VOICES: PACHELBEL  (C: RUN SID6 IN THE SHELL)
0  SID12      FOUR SIDS, TWELVE VOICES         (C: RUN SID12)
1  INVADERS   SPACE INVADERS ON THE TEXT SCREEN
B  BENCHMARKS MENU
*  K/OS COMMANDS: *DIR, *CD EHBASIC, *TYPE NAME, *INFO ... (@ WORKS TOO)
Q  QUIT TO READY

CHOICE?

```

The demo menu. A key picks an entry; each demo returns here when it ends.

### 3.3 Hardware sprites

The 128 sprites VICKY carries are reachable from BASIC, which is unusual enough to be worth saying plainly: this is not a bitmap being re-drawn, it is the video chip carrying the picture for you.

```

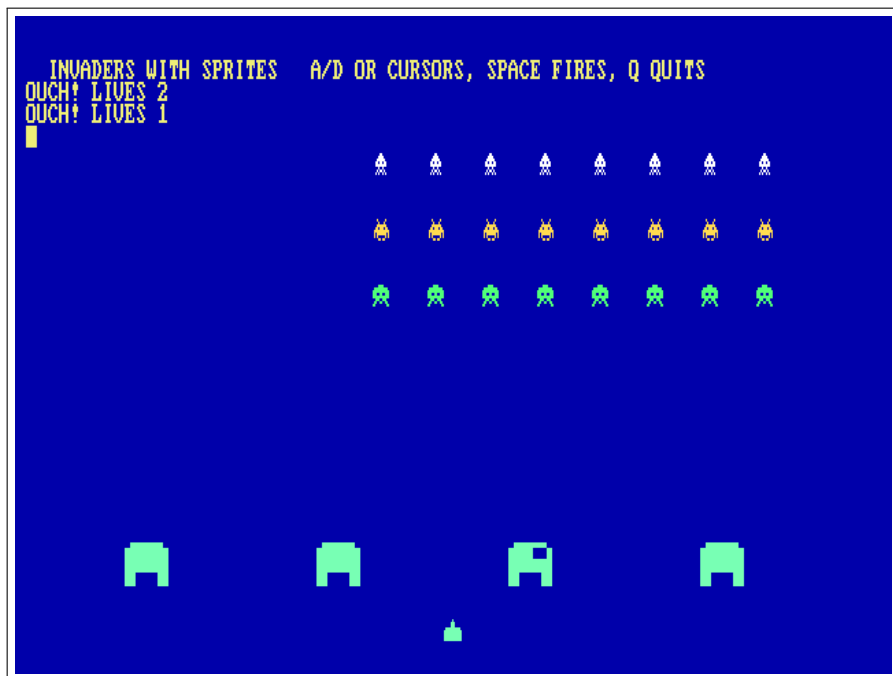
SPRDEF n,page,w,h,bpp  give sprite n a shape
SPRITE n,x,y           put it there and show it
SPROFF n               hide it

```

SPRDEF says where the pixels are and what shape they make: *page* is the 256-byte page the data starts at, which is how a 16-bit BASIC number reaches into 256 MB ( $\text{page} \times 256$  is the address); *w* and *h* are 8, 16, 32 or 64; *bpp* is 4 or 8. SPRITE positions the sprite and turns it on, SPROFF hides it. Colour 0 is transparent, and there is no per-line limit — all 128 may be on the same raster line.

Each statement re-points the chip at the attribute table and re-enables sprites, so a GRAPHICS 0 or a shell MODE in between costs you nothing: the next sprite statement puts them back.

INVADER2.BAS in /EHBASIC is the demonstration — Space Invaders with the arcade shapes, poked 4 bits-per-pixel into \$040000 through a bank register, four bases that erode as they are hit, and thirty-one sprites moving. INVADERS.BAS beside it is the same game on the text screen, which is a fair way to see what the sprites buy you.



INVADER2.BAS: twenty-four invaders, four bases and a cannon, every one of them a hardware sprite. The bases erode because their shape pages are poked, not redrawn.

### 3.4 The \* escape

Any shell command works from BASIC with \* in front — \*DIR, \*CD EHBASIC, \*MON, \*DUMP a note — and \*BYE leaves BASIC for the shell (@ is accepted



too, a survivor from an earlier machine). Escape or Ctrl-C stops a running program (and silences the SIDs); the program's variables survive for PRINT-style post-mortems.

## 3.5 Editing the program in VI

\*VI and \*EDIT, with nothing after them, edit the program that is in memory:

```
10 PRINT "HELLO"  
*VI
```

BASIC writes the program to a temp file, opens the editor on it, and reads it back when you leave — so what you type in the editor is what you LIST afterwards. Give either one a file name and nothing special happens: \*VI notes.txt is the ordinary \* escape, and the editor edits that file.

The trip out and back is not free. The editors load where the interpreter lives, so the shell command underneath is SWAP, which puts all 64 KB and the screen aside first and restores them afterwards. And because the program is written out and read back, *variables do not survive* — this is an immediate-mode thing, like LOAD. The temp file (EDITTMP.BAS) is left behind, which is occasionally a useful accident.

**Why the first line is blank:** SAVE starts its output with a newline, so the editor opens on an empty line 1 with the program below it. Harmless — BASIC ignores it on the way back in — but it is why the line count is one more than you expect.

## Chapter 4

# The Tube: BBC BASIC

The BBC Micro's most elegant idea was the Tube: a fast port through which a *second processor* — another CPU with its own memory — could take over the computation while the Beeb kept the keyboard, the screen and the discs. The BMC-K4510 has a Tube of its own at \$D800, and the first thing fitted to it is Richard Russell's BBC BASIC, running on the host machine with a flat 256 MB of its own.

```
BBC
```

You get the > prompt of a BASIC with real power behind it, and it is *fast* — the co-processor is not cycle-matched to 1985:

```
HIMEM=PAGE+250*1024*1024  
DIM space 200*1024*1024
```

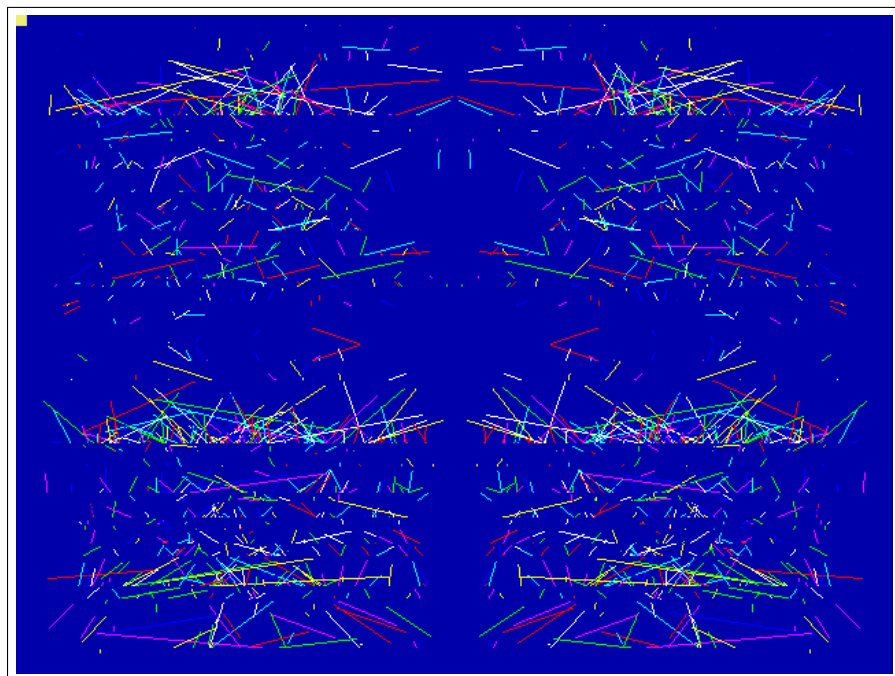
both just work. Type \*QUIT to hand the console back to the shell.

## 4.1 Graphics and sound

The console cannot show what it cannot see, so the Tube speaks up: MODE, GCOL, PLOT, MOVE, DRAW, CIRCLE and the palette arrive at the machine as escape sequences, and the Tube's gatekeeper (the *Tube ULA*) executes them on the VICKY blitter. SOUND and ENVELOPE-less music go the same way, onto the machine's four-channel sound sequencer and out through the SIDs — the classic Beeb SOUND chan,amp,pitch,dur, queued per channel like the original.

```
LOAD "BBCBASIC/KALEID.BBC"  
RUN
```

The /BBCBASIC directory carries a period programme selection: KALEID, CIRCLES, ROSES, MOUNTAIN, BOUNCE, CLOCK (a live analogue clock



KALEID.BBC: MODE 2 kaleidoscope, drawn by BBC BASIC on the Tube, painted by VICKY.

face) and TUNE — Frère Jacques as a three-voice round, the sound sequencer's party piece.

## 4.2 Sprites

VICKY has 128 hardware sprites, and BBC BASIC reaches them the way RISC OS reached its own: VDU 23,27 selects and shapes, PLOT & ED places. There is no sprite file. A sprite is *captured* from the bitmap after BBC BASIC has drawn it with the words it already knows:

```

MODE 2
GCOL 0,1:CIRCLE FILL 40,40,30
MOVE 8,6:VDU 23,27,1,0,32,32|
CLG
PLOT &ED,600,500

```

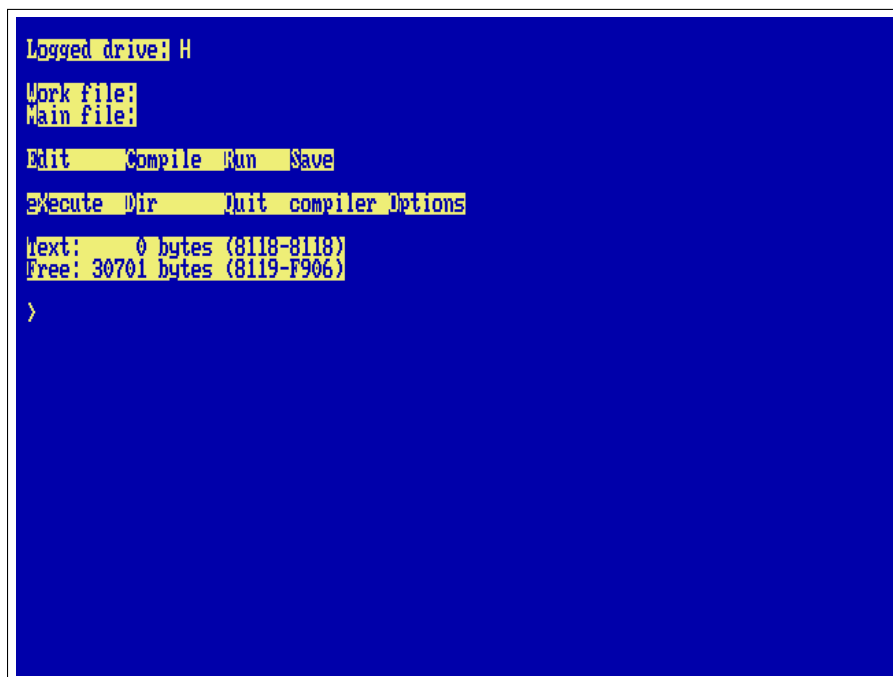
|                   |                                                                                       |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| VDU 23,27,0,n     | select sprite $n$ (0–127) for PLOT                                                    |
| VDU 23,27,1,n,w,h | capture $n$ , $w \times h$ pixels (8/16/32/64),<br>bottom-left at the graphics cursor |
| VDU 23,27,2,n     | hide $n$                                                                              |
| VDU 23,27,3,n,f   | flip: bit 0 horizontal, bit 1 vertical                                                |
| VDU 23,27,4,n,z   | depth: drawn after layer $z$ (default 1, over<br>the bitmap)                          |
| VDU 23,27,5,n,m   | sprite $n$ shows sprite $m$ 's picture                                                |
| PLOT &ED,x,y      | show the selected sprite, bottom-left at<br>$x, y$                                    |

A placed sprite is a register write: moving sixty-four of them every frame costs the interpreter nothing but the PLOTS. `SPRITES.BBC`, `INVADERS.BBC` and `TUNNEL.BBC` in `/BBCBASIC` are the demonstrations (the last one moves nothing at all — it cycles the palette with VDU 19).

## 4.3 The terminal: JIM

The console you see when the Tube is running is not the ROM's own terminal but *JIM*, at \$DA00 — the Beeb's third I/O page, given a job here. JIM is a VT100 with the ANSI colours and the VT220 editing sequences (insert and delete character and line, erase character, scroll regions, origin mode, DEC line drawing, cursor-position and identity reports), built into the machine the way a real 8-bit computer got a serious terminal: as a card, not a program. It draws on the same text screen as the ROM console, inside the window the ROM gives it, so the two share one screen and one cursor. Anything that needs a terminal writes its byte stream to \$DA00 and reads its answers from \$DA02; keys pushed through \$DA03 come back as the VT sequences the far end expects (arrows, Home/End, PgUp/PgDn, F1–F12, Delete as \$7F). The register map is in `core/term.h`.

For CP/M this settles the question every program asks at install time: tell WordStar's `WSCHANGE`, Turbo Pascal's `TINST`, `ZDE` and the rest that the terminal is a *VT100* (or *ANSI*: the same sequences). Turbo Pascal 3



Turbo Pascal 3 (H: user 3) on JIM: the menu bar in reverse video, the compiler's own screen handling on a VT100 that is a chip.

on H: user 3 comes up with its menu already right; WordStar 4 on E: wants one pass of WSCCHANGE. BBC BASIC's console edition speaks the same language natively, so COLOUR, CLS and PRINT TAB(x,y) land where they should. Bytes \$80–\$FF are drawn as CP437 glyphs, which is what BBS ANSI art is made of.

## 4.4 Star commands

A line starting with \* goes to the machine: \*DIR, \*CD, any shell command — and BBC BASIC's own file words (LOAD, SAVE) read and write the machine's filesystem directly, because the co-processor lives inside fs/ too. The Tube starts in the shell's current directory, so CD BBCBASIC then BBC lets LOAD "KALEID.BBC" work with no directory prefix; the machine's filesystem is the co-processor's whole world — fs/ is shown as /, the

host tree above it hidden, and \*CD .. stops at the root.

**Edges, honestly:** POINT( and TINT are not implemented; GCOL modes 1–4 draw plain; VDU 5 text prints as text. On the Pi both co-processors run on core 3, the second processor.

## Chapter 5

# Forth

The machine's third language is native: no Tube, no co-processor, just 45GS10 machine code loaded at \$4000. It is Tali Forth 2 — a public-domain, ANS-flavoured Forth written for the 65C02, which this CPU speaks as a strict superset.

```
FORTH
```

```
2 3 + . 5 ok
: cube dup dup * * ; ok
7 cube . 343 ok
```

### 5.1 The machine at your fingertips

Forth's oldest habit is poking hardware, and this machine is one large, friendly memory map. C@ and C! reach every register of Chapter 10 directly:

```
hex
D000 C@ .      read a VICKY register
D5E0 80 swap C! HUSH, by hand: silence the sequencer
```

### 5.2 The assembler

Tali brings an interactive 65C02 assembler and a disassembler, kept in because on this machine they are the point:

```
4000 10 disasm      disassemble the Forth kernel itself
assembler-wordlist >order
here 2 lda.# 0 sta.z drop
```

```

CPU: 45GS10 at 40.5 MHz + runCPM Tube
RAM: 256 000 000 bytes
CHIPS: 4 reSID, VICKY, SHEILA, FRED, JIM

STARTUP.BAT -- hold a key to skip
STARTUP.BAT skipped
/1 forth
Tali Forth 2 on the BMC-K4510 (native 45GS10)

Tali Forth 2 for the 65c02
Version 1.1 06. Apr 2024
Copyright 2014-2024 Scot W. Stevenson, Sam Colwell, Patrick Surry
Tali Forth 2 comes with absolutely NO WARRANTY
Type 'bye' to exit
2 3 + . 5 ok
: cube dup dup * * ; ok
7 cube . 343 ok
hex 4000 10 disasm
4000 0 brk
4002 0 brk
4004 0 brk
4006 0 brk
4008 0 brk
400A 0 brk
400C 0 brk
400E 0 brk
ok

```

A Forth session: the banner, arithmetic, a new word, and the kernel disassembling itself.

DISASM is strictly 65C02: at a 45GS10-only opcode it prints a polite ? and moves on.

## 5.3 Manners

The dictionary has about 31.7 KB free for your words. BYE returns to the shell with the screen and the session exactly as you left them.

No file words yet: Forth source lives in /FORTH but must be typed. An INCLUDED that reads through the machine's storage device is on the list.



## Chapter 6

# CP/M: the Z80 Second Processor

In 1984 Acorn sold a Z80 Second Processor for the BBC Micro; its purpose was to run CP/M, the operating system that owned business computing before the IBM PC. It sat on the Tube. So does ours. CPM at the shell boots CP/M 2.2 on a Z80 co-processor (RunCPM, on the host), and the A0> prompt that defined a decade appears. The boot banner cheerfully measures the Z80 in *gigahertz* — read that number knowingly: it is the emulated Z80's speed *on whatever host you run the emulator on* (a laptop, in this book's screenshots), so it varies machine to machine. For scale, the real thing shipped at 4 MHz.

CPM

## 6.1 Drives are folders

Drives A: to P: are the host folders fs/CPM/A through fs/CPM/P; CP/M's user areas 0–15 are numbered subfolders. Drop any .COM file into fs/CPM/A/0 and run it by name. DIR, TYPE, ERA, REN, SAVE and USER are built into the CCP; EXIT hands the console back to the K/OS shell.

Three of the drives are shortcuts rather than folders of their own: K: is the machine's own filesystem, so CP/M and K/OS can hand files to each other in both directions; P: is Turbo Pascal and D: is WordStar, each pointing straight at the user area the program lives in.

## 6.2 Starting a program from the shell

CPM on its own gives you the A0> prompt. CPM command runs a command at boot instead, through the CCP's AUTOEXEC.TXT. One line is all the CCP reads — but a name with no .COM to match runs the .SUB of that name, and that may be as long as you like. /CPM/A/0/K-TURBO.SUB is the pattern:

```

A: ED      COM | EXIT   COM | EXIT   SUB | EXIT   Z80
A: FORMAT  COM | FORMAT SUB | FORMAT Z80 | INFO   COM
A: INFO    SUB | INFO   TXT | INFO   Z80 | K-MBAS SUB
A: K-TURBO SUB | K-US   SUB | LOAD   COM | LST    TXT
A: LU      COM | MAC    COM | MAKEFCB LIB | MBASIC COM
A: MDIR    COM | MLOAD  ASM | MLOAD  COM | MLOAD  DOC
A: MOVCPM  COM | OPCODES DOC | PIP    COM | README TXT
A: RSTAT   COM | RSTAT  SUB | RSTAT  Z80 | RUNUT  BAS
A: SLRASM  COM | STAT   COM | SUBMIT  COM | SUBMITD COM
A: SVSGEN  COM | TE     COM | UNARC   COM | UNCR   COM
A: UNZIP   COM | USQ    COM | XMODEM  COM | XSUB   COM
A: Z2HDR   LIB | Z3BASE LIB | Z3HDR  LIB | Z80ASM COM
A: Z80ASM  PDF | Z80CCP ASM | Z80CCP SUB | ZCPR2  ASM
A: ZCPR2   SUB | ZCPR3  ASM | ZCPR3  SUB | ZEX     COM
A: ZEX     Z80 | ZEXALL  COM | ZEXDOC  COM | ZSID   COM
A: ZTRAN   COM

```

```
A0>type readme.txt
```

```
CP/M 2.2 ON THE BMC-K4510
```

```
-----
You are on the Z80 second processor (a 3 GHz Z80, as it happens),
reached over the Tube. Acorn sold exactly this in 1984.
```

```
Drives A: to P: are the folders fs/CPM/A ... fs/CPM/P on the host;
user areas 0-15 are subfolders. Drop .COM files in and run them.
```

```
DIR, TYPE, ERA, REN, $AUE and USER are built into the CCP.
EXIT returns to the K/OS shell.
```

```
A0>|
```

CP/M 2.2 over the Tube: the CCP's DIR and TYPE, on drive A.

```
P:
TURBO
EXIT
```

Ending in EXIT is what makes the round trip whole: quitting a CP/M program only drops you to the CCP, and the EXIT carries you the rest of the way back to the K/OS prompt. With that in place ALIAS TURBO CPM K-TURBO makes TURBO a word you can type at the shell; /SYSTEM/STARTUP.SAMPLE defines that one, WS and MBASIC.

**Why not USER in a submit.** The obvious script is H:, USER 3, TURBO — and it dies on the second line. The submit in progress is a file, \$\$\$SUB, and it lives on A: user 0; USER 3 walks away from it and it cannot be read any more. That is CP/M's own behaviour and not RunCPM's doing. Pointing a drive at the user area, as P: and D: do,

keeps USER out of it.

## 6.3 Typing a CP/M program's name directly

The shell can be told to treat an unknown word as a CP/M program: F7 → Shell → *CP/M.COM by name*. With it on, STAT at the /] prompt starts CP/M, runs STAT.COM from A: and comes back.

It is off to begin with, and deliberately so — D typed for DIR should not start a Z80 program. It changes only the guess: a command naming CPM outright, an alias among them, works either way. There is nothing in a .prg to tell the two apart, incidentally — its header is a load address and a run address, and a .COM begins with Z80 code that would read as a perfectly plausible one — so the extension is what decides.

## 6.4 Software

The RunCPM project ships a complete system disk (DISK/A0.zip in its repository): Digital Research's own ASM, MAC, DDT, ZSID, STAT, PIP and ED, the SUBMIT batch system, Microsoft BASIC, a Z80 assembler with its manual, XMODEM, and the source code of the BDOS and CCP — buildable on the machine itself. One `unzip A0.zip -d fs/CPM/` installs the lot. Beyond that lies the whole surviving CP/M software world: WordStar, Turbo Pascal, dBase II, Zork, one archive away.

**Edges, honestly:** line-mode programs (assemblers, compilers, MBASIC, adventures) work today, and so does the full-screen software: the console is JIM, a VT100 in hardware (Chapter 4). WordStar 4 on E: user 3 comes installed for “ANSI Standard” at 79×29 — WS and you are editing; Turbo Pascal 3 on H: user 3 needs nothing either. A program that asks its terminal type at install time wants “VT100” or “ANSI”.

```

E:READ.ME          P01 L01 C01 Insert Align          Large-File
          E D I T   M E N U
CURSOR      SCROLL    ERASE    OTHER          MENUS
^E up        ^W up      ^G char    ^J help      ^O onscreen format
^X down      ^Z down    ^T word    ^I tab       ^K block & save
^S left      ^R up screen ^Y line   ^U turn insert off ^P print controls
^D right      ^C down    Del char   ^B align paragraph ^Q quick functions
^A word left  screen    ^U unerase ^N split the line  Esc shorthand
^F word right

L-----!-----!-----!-----!-----!-----!-----R
                        --THE README FILE--
                        -----

README contains late-breaking news and tips about WordStar,
and information about printers.

THE DISKS THAT CAME IN YOUR PACKAGE
-----

The file HOMONYMS.TXT is included on the Speller disk
contrary to what is listed in Appendix D.

INSTALLATION
-----

WINSTALL and USCHANGE

```

WordStar 4 editing its own READ.ME: the edit menu, the ruler, the text —  
79×29 on JIM.

Desktop host only, like the rest of the Tube.

## Chapter 7

# Pascal

The machine has two Pascals, and they are different animals. Turbo Pascal 3 runs on the Tube under CP/M (Chapter 6): an on-machine compiler, a Z80 program, its own world. *Mad Pascal* is the other kind — a cross-compiler, like cc65 the ROM is built with: you write on the desktop, mp compiles to 6502 assembly, MADS assembles it, and the result is a .prg the shell's RUN loads like any other program. It is Tomasz Biela's compiler (MIT), a Turbo-Pascal-flavoured language with 8-, 16- and 32-bit integers, fixed and floating point, strings, records, pointers, units and inline assembly, made for the Atari and since taught the C64, the X16 and the Neo6502. The K4510 is its newest target.

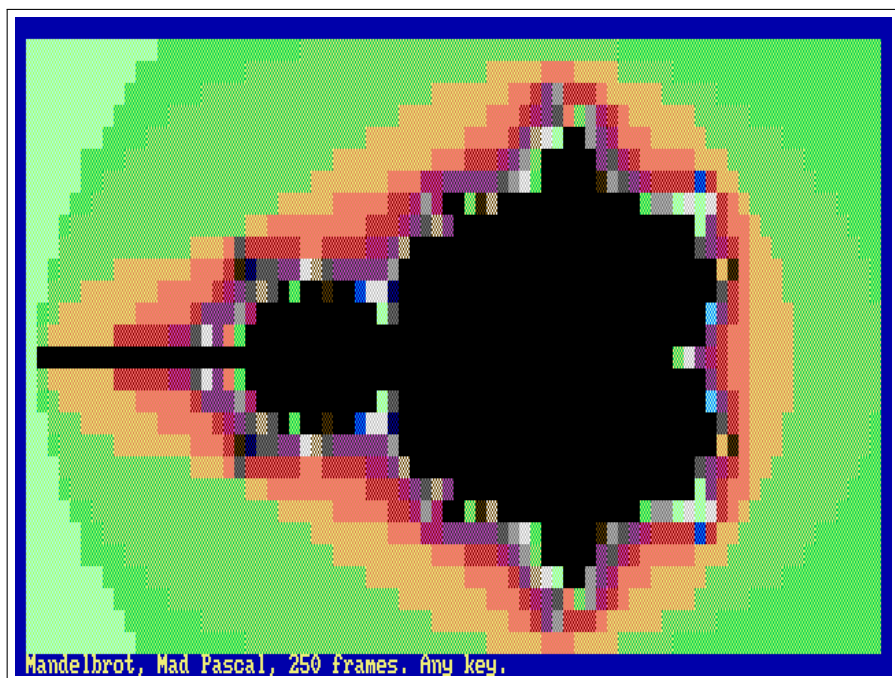
### PMANDEL

That is demo/pas/pmandel.pas: the Mandelbrot set, 78 by 28 cells in the machine's sixteen colours, in a little over four seconds at 40.5 MHz — fixed point, 32-bit integers, forty lines of Pascal. PSIEVE is the classic sieve, ten passes timed by the frame counter; HELLO prints, shows the colours, and echoes what you typed after its name.

## 7.1 The target

Everything a Pascal program needs from the machine is in pascal/ of the repository, laid out as it lives inside a Mad-Pascal checkout: the runtime base (base/rtl6502\_k4510.asm and base/k4510/), where @putchar writes to JIM, the terminal (Chapter 4); the SYSTEM and CRT units' machine halves (lib/\*\_k4510.inc); and a k4510 unit. The consequences for the programmer:

- Write and WriteLn go through JIM, so the CRT unit is the real thing: GotoXY, TextColor and TextBackground (the palette's constants: BLUE, YELLOW, LIGHT\_GREEN...), ClrScr, ClrEol, InsLine/DelLine,



PMANDEL: the Mandelbrot set in text, sixteen colours through JIM, in 250 frames.

WhereX/WhereY, CursorOn/CursorOff, ReadKey and KeyPressed on the keyboard device, Delay and Pause on the frame counter, Sound on SID 0. TextMode(0) puts the ROM's screen back.

- ParamCount and ParamStr come from the shell line (RUN HELLO one two, or just HELLO one two); ParamStr(0) is the whole tail.
- uses k4510 gives every chip as a typed variable at its address — VICKY[reg], SIDREG[], DMA\_SRC, FS\_CMD, SYS\_FRAMES, MATH\_F[], TERM\_CX and the rest — plus FarPeek/FarPoke into the 256 MB through the 45GS02's flat addressing, DmaCopy/DmaFill, Shell('DIR'), LoadFile/SaveFile through the ROM, WaitVBlank, and TermWrite for raw escape sequences.
- Memory: code from \$0800, the program's own; zero page \$22--\$3F for the compiler's registers and \$64--\$A3 for its expression stack

(the ROM keeps \$02--\$21 and \$F0--\$F9); \$0300 the string buffer. Programs return to the shell with the ROM's state intact.

## 7.2 Building

On the desktop, with FPC and a Mad-Pascal checkout (the installer patches its target table and rebuilds mp). It looks for the checkout in ~/Projects/neo6502\_dev/Mad-Pascal unless MP\_DIR says otherwise:

```
make pascal-install    # once; MP_DIR=... to point elsewhere
make pascal            # demo/pas/*.pas -> fs/PRG/*.prg
```

A new program is a file in demo/pas/; make finds it. The compiled .prg files are committed, so a machine without the toolchain still runs them, and the test suite (test/pastest.sh) runs HELLO and PSIEVE through the ROM.

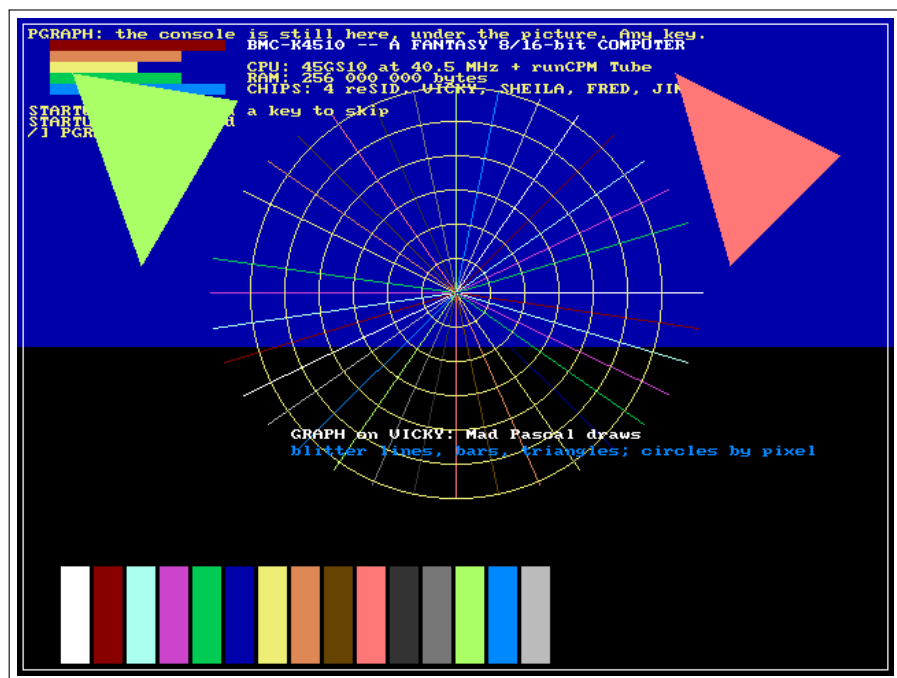
## 7.3 Floating point on the MATH unit

single (IEEE-754, 32-bit) does not run in software here. The runtime's add, subtract, multiply, divide, compare, Trunc, Round and Frac are the MATH unit at \$D700 (Chapter 10): each is a few register moves and one write to FOP, and the unit answers in the next cycle. PFloat times five thousand rounds of multiply, divide, add and subtract: 5 frames on the unit, 24 with the software library (assemble with mads -d:SOFTFLOAT=1 to get it back for comparison). The transcendentals are in the k4510 unit — MathSqrt, MathSin, MathCos, MathTan, MathAtan, MathAtan2, MathExp, MathLn, MathPow, MathFloor — one register write each, alongside the SYSTEM unit's own polynomial Sqrt, Sin and Cos, which still work and are still slower.

## 7.4 Graphics on VICKY

uses graph draws on VICKY's layer 1: a 640×480 8-bit bitmap at \$200000 — the one BBC BASIC's ULA uses too — over the console, which stays visible wherever the picture is transparent (colour 0), as in

a BBC MODE. InitGraph(0) switches the video to 480 lines and clears the bitmap; CloseGraph puts the console's mode back. PutPixel and GetPixel go through the 45GS02's flat addressing (the MEGA65 multiplier does the row arithmetic); Line, LineTo and the K4510 additions DrawLine, FillBar and FillTriangle are the blitter's LINE, FILL and TRIANGLE operations — one register write each; Circle, Ellipse, Rectangle and the rest of Mad Pascal's generic GRAPH build on those; OutTextXY writes with the console's font. PGRAPH is the demonstration.



PGRAPH: bars, a star and triangles by the blitter, circles by pixel, text from the ROM's font — and the console's own line still on top.

Note that SYSTEM's Sqrt/Sin/Cos/ArcTan/Exp/Ln on single also run on the MATH unit now: the installer patches system.pas under `{ifdef k4510}`.



## Chapter 8

# The Editors

Two of them, because they answer different questions. EDIT is the one to reach for when a file wants a line changed and you want to be out again in ten seconds. VI is the one for a file too big to think about, and it is modal, so it expects you to have met vi before.

Both draw through JIM, the VT100 in hardware (Chapter 4), and both take their keys raw from the ROM — an arrow arrives as one byte rather than an escape sequence to unpick. Neither needs the Tube, so both run on the Pi as well as the desktop.

### 8.1 EDIT

EDIT name opens a file, or starts an empty one if there is no such file yet. The whole text sits in memory below the program, so it holds about 22 KB — ample for a STARTUP.BAT, a .SUB, a BASIC listing or a letter.

|                           |                |
|---------------------------|----------------|
| arrows Home End PgUp PgDn | move           |
| Backspace Delete          | rub out        |
| Enter                     | split the line |
| Ctrl-O or Ctrl-S          | save           |
| Ctrl-X                    | leave          |

The bar along the bottom carries the name, a \* while there are unsaved changes, where the cursor is, and those last two keys, so there is nothing to remember. Backspace at the start of a line joins it to the one above. Long lines slide sideways rather than wrap. Ctrl-X on a changed file says so and waits: press it again to throw the changes away, or Ctrl-O to keep them.

## 8.2 VI

VI name is modal in the old way: the keys are commands until *i* (or *a*, *I*, *A*, *o*, *O*) puts you into insert, and Escape brings you back out.

```
counts    3dd 5j 2dw 10G      before almost anything
move      h j k l arrows  w b e 0 ^ $ gg G PgUp PgDn
operate   d c y + any motion, or doubled: dd cc yy
insert    i a I A o O s S C      Esc leaves insert
change    x X r ~ J D p P (the unnamed register)
undo      u                      redo Ctrl-R
search    /pat ?pat n N
ex        :w :q :q! :wq :x
          :s/old/new/[g] :%s/old/new/[g]
          :map lhs rhs      :imap lhs rhs
```

A count goes in front of nearly anything: 3dd deletes three lines, 2dw two words, 10G goes to line ten. Operators take any motion — *d c y* with *w*, *b*, *e*, *0*, *^*, *\$*, *G* — or double themselves to work on whole lines. What *d*, *x* or *y* took goes into the unnamed register for *p* and *P*. Undo is unlimited, and so is redo: the journal lives in far memory with the file, so one level would have cost the same as all of them.

:map and :imap define your own keys — :imap *jk* <Esc> is the usual one — and last for the session.

Two behaviours are deliberate and worth knowing before they surprise you. A charwise operator **clamps to the line**: *dw* at the end of a line stops there instead of eating into the next one. And a search is a **plain substring**, not a pattern — */foo* finds *foo*, and *.* *\** *[* mean themselves. So does the left-hand side of *:s*.

:q on a changed file refuses and says so; :q! throws the changes away and :wq keeps them. :w name writes somewhere else. Lines past the end of the file are marked ~ down the left, as they should be.

**Where the file lives.** Nothing of it is in the 64 KB. Every line is a 256-byte slot in far memory — a length and up to 255 characters — and only the line under the cursor is brought down, fetched when the cursor arrives and written back when it leaves. So the ceiling is

far memory rather than the address space: 32000 lines, and LOAD and SAVE go straight to and from a flat copy out there without the file ever passing through the CPU's view.

That is the whole design, and it is deliberately the *only* design: there is no small-file case kept separately to disagree with the large one at exactly the wrong moment. It costs nothing because the DMA engine copies with `memmove` semantics, so opening or closing a line is a single transfer of everything below it however long the file is.

A 1.28 MB file of 20000 lines — twenty times the whole address space — opens, edits at the far end and saves back byte for byte.

### 8.3 Editing without losing what you were doing

A program loaded from the shell lands on top of whatever was in memory, so running an editor from inside a BASIC would ordinarily destroy the program you were writing. SWAP (Chapter 2) is the way round it:

```
*SWAP EDIT MYPROG.BAS
```

from EhBASIC puts the machine away, runs the editor on a clean one, and gives yours back — program, variables, screen and all — when the editor exits.

# **Part II**

## **Programmer's Guide**

## Chapter 9

# Memory

### 9.1 The 64 KB view and the 256 MB behind it

The 45GS10's program counter is 16 bits: code executes inside a 64 KB window. The 256 MB of physical memory is reached three ways:

- **Flat pointers:** LDA [ptr],Z and the Q forms read and write any byte of the 256 MB directly. Data never needs banking.
- **Bank registers** (\$D600, one per 8 KB block): write a 28-bit base and that block of the window shows that memory. Bytes 0–2 set the base; byte 3 switches (bit 7 = off).
- **DMA** (\$D200): copy, fill, swap, line, triangle — instant, physical addresses.

### 9.2 The CPU view, unmapped

---

|               |        |                                             |
|---------------|--------|---------------------------------------------|
| \$0000–\$03FF | system | zero page, stack, vectors, low system state |
| \$0800–\$CFFF | user   | 50 KB for programs, ROM-free at launch      |
| \$A000–\$BFFF | ROM    | <i>the sideways window; RAM underneath</i>  |
| \$C000–\$CFFF | ROM    | <i>RAM underneath, bankable</i>             |
| \$D000–\$DFFF | I/O    | always I/O, whatever is banked              |
| \$E000–\$FEFF | ROM    | <i>RAM underneath, bankable</i>             |
| \$FF00–\$FFFF | stub   | always ROM: system-call stub and vectors    |

---

### 9.3 RAM under the ROM

rom\_out() (or three pokes to the bank registers) banks blocks 5–7 onto the RAM beneath the ROM: a program then owns \$0800–\$CFFF + \$E000–\$FEFF = 57 KB. Every system call still works — calls go through

the \$FF00 stub page, which banks the ROM in and out around them. RUN romout demonstrates the whole mechanism on screen.

## 9.4 Sideways ROM

The operating system is bigger than its half of the 64 KB — so, like the BBC Micro before it, the machine grew *sideways*. The ROM file is a 24 KB base image plus appended 8 KB banks; cold commands live in the \$A000-\$BFFF window (bank 0 is the base image itself, INFO and TIME already run from bank 1), and the shell pages the right bank in around each call. System calls work throughout: every call already passes through the always-ROM stub page at \$FF00, which banks the ROM view in and out. Up to sixteen banks — 128 KB of operating system — fit in the scheme.

## 9.5 RAM under the I/O page

A MAP of block 6 hides \$D000-\$DFFF and exposes RAM: with the ROM also banked away a program owns a contiguous field from \$0800 to \$FEFF — 61.75 KB of the 64. The trick that makes it safe is that MAP is an *instruction*, not a register: the program that hid the I/O can always ask for it back, so there is no way to lock yourself out. (The far-call gate is unreachable while block 6 is mapped; unmap before far calls.)

## 9.6 Programs bigger than the window

The K4SG executable format loads segments to any physical address and the far-call gate (\$DF00) calls between them: a plain JSR into slot *n* banks descriptor *n*'s code in, and the callee's RTS banks it back out. RUN segdemo shows two overlays sharing one address.

## Chapter 10

# The I/O Page

One page, \$D000-\$DFFF, always visible. The authoritative register-level reference is the machine's own headers, and Appendix A is generated from them at build time — the way the Neo6502 handbook generates its keyword reference from the firmware source. This chapter is the map of what lives where:

---

|        |          |                                                                                           |
|--------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$D000 | VICKY    | video: layers, palette, blitter, sprites, SHEILA                                          |
| \$D100 | input    | keyboard FIFO, status, peek, break-pending                                                |
| \$D200 | DMA      | copy / fill / swap / line / triangle                                                      |
| \$D300 | storage  | the host filesystem: open, read, dir, chdir...                                            |
| \$D400 | SID 0-3  | four chips, 32 bytes apart                                                                |
| \$D500 | system   | clock, RTC, frame counter, DUMP, SID crystal                                              |
| \$D600 | banks    | the eight bank registers, masks at \$D620                                                 |
| \$D700 | MATH     | IEEE floats, transcendentals, math lists, mul/div                                         |
| \$D800 | Tube     | the co-processor: status, byte in, byte out, start/stop                                   |
| \$D900 | N:       | the network: four channels, tcp://, http(s):// and tnfs:// (see core/net.h)               |
| \$DA00 | JIM      | the terminal: a VT100/ANSI in hardware, drawing on the console's screen (see core/term.h) |
| \$DF00 | far gate | call slots, descriptor table pointer, depth                                               |

---

## Chapter A

# The Registers

Everything the machine's devices do, they do through the I/O page. This appendix is the register-level reference, and it is not written by hand: `doc/guide/mkregs.py` lifts it out of the machine's own headers at build time, so what you read here is what the emulator was compiled against. When a device gains a register, this appendix gains it in the next build — which is the only way a reference of this kind stays true.

Nothing in it is reworded: every word below is a word from a header. What the generator decides is only which column a word belongs in — the address on the left, the register's name after it, the comment's own sentence following. Where a comment's own spacing was doing the work of a table, that table is kept exactly as it was written, in monospace, because there it is the spacing that carries the meaning.

The voice is still the voice of working code: terse, occasionally opinionated, and using the machine's own shorthand — LE for little-endian, R: and W: for a register that reads and writes differently, \$ for hex. Addresses are given as an offset inside the device's block where the block's base is obvious, and in full where it is not.

Chapter 10 is the map of which device lives where; this is what is inside each one.

## A.1 The I/O page

Generated from `core/io.h`.

### Bank registers and the far gate

BANK registers:  $\$0600 + 4n$ ,  $n = 0..7$ , one per 8 KB block of the CPU view.

|           |                                                                                                                               |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| bytes 0-2 | physical base bits 0-23 (little-endian); they only set the base                                                               |
| byte 3    | bits 24-27 of the base, and bit 7 = OFF. Writing byte 3 switches the block: bit 7 clear = on, set = off. (So STQ works, and a |



byte-wise save/restore never switches a block on by accident.)  
Reads give the base; byte 3 reads \$FF while the block is off.

\$D620 read: bit n = block n banked

\$D621 read: MAP mask (bit n = MAPPED)

A banked block resolves  $\text{phys} = \text{base} + (\text{cpu} \& \$1\text{FFF})$ . MAP rewrites all eight blocks, so the ROM's "MAP off" at program exit clears the banks too. The I/O page \$D000-\$DFFF and the stub page \$FF00-\$FFFF stay visible whatever is banked, so banking blocks 6 and 7 reveals the RAM under the ROM only. FAR gate: JSR \$DF00 + 4n calls descriptor n of the table at FARTAB.

\$DF00-\$DF7F 32 call slots

\$DFF0 return gate (RTS lands here)

\$DF80-\$DF83 FARTAB 28-bit pointer to the descriptor table (read/write)

\$DF84 read: nesting depth

\$DF85 read: last error (1 overflow, 2 underflow, 3 bad slot); write clears descriptor, 8 bytes: base[4] block flags entry[2]; flags bit0 leave banked on return, bit1 do not bank (long jump to resident code). A/X/Y/Z pass through both ways: cc65 \_\_fastcall\_\_ works across it.

## The MATH unit

MATH unit. Results are ready the cycle after the write that triggers them.

\$D700-\$D71F **F0..F7** eight IEEE-754 single registers, little-endian, read/write

\$D720 **FOP** write = execute; low 5 bits op, see below

\$D721 **FARG** (dst  $\ll$  4) | src, register numbers 0..7, write before FOP

\$D722 **FFLAGS** from the last op: bit0 result zero, bit1 negative, bit2 NaN/inf

\$D724-\$D727 **FI** int32 for ITOF / FTOI

ops: 0 MOV Fd=Fs 1 ADD 2 SUB 3 MUL 4 DIV (Fd = Fd op Fs)  
5 SQRT 6 SIN 7 COS 8 TAN 9 ATAN 10 EXP 11 LOG 14 ABS 15 NEG 16 FLOOR 17 ROUND (Fd = f(Fs))  
10 ATAN2 (Fd = atan2(Fd,Fs)) 13 POW (Fd = Fd^Fs) 21 FMOD (Fd = fmod(Fd,Fs))  
18 CMP flags from Fd - Fs, registers unchanged  
19 ITOF Fd = (float)FI 20 FTOI FI = (int32)Fs, truncated

Math list – a program for the unit in RAM, run with one write:

\$D728-\$D72B **MLPTR** 28-bit pointer to the list

\$D72C **MLRUN** write = run from MLPTR until END or a STOP fires

|               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$D72D        | <b>MLSTAT</b> 0 reached END, 1 a STOP fired, \$FF runaway (65536 ops)                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| \$D72E,\$D72F | <b>MLCNT</b> 16-bit counter for DJNZ, read/write<br>list ops, 2 bytes each (op, arg) unless noted; ops 0..21 are the FOP ops with arg = (dst«4) src, and in addition:                                                                                                                           |
| \$80          | <b>END</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| \$81          | <b>STOPNEG</b> stop if last flags negative                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| \$82          | <b>STOPPOS</b> if not negative                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$83          | <b>STOPZERO</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| \$84          | <b>STOPNZ</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| \$85          | <b>JUMP</b> arg (signed, in ops from the next op)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| \$86          | <b>DJNZ</b> arg MLCNT–, jump if nonzero                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| \$87          | <b>STOPFI</b> arg stop if FI >= arg (unsigned byte compare on the low byte, FI clamped)                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| \$88          | <b>LDF</b> arg=dst«4, then 4 bytes: IEEE single immediate into Fdst (6-byte op)                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| \$89          | <b>LDI</b> , then 4 bytes: int32 immediate into FI (6-byte op)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$8A          | <b>LDMS</b> arg=dst«4, then 4 bytes: 28-bit address of a Microsoft-format float (exponent excess-128, mantissa1 with sign in bit 7, mantissa2, mantissa3 – EhBASIC’s packed variable format); converted into Fdst (6-byte op)<br>MEGA65-compatible integer unit (same addresses as the MEGA65): |
| \$D770–\$D773 | <b>MULTINA</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$D774–\$D777 | <b>MULTINB</b> (unsigned 32-bit, LE)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| \$D778–\$D77F | <b>MULTOUT</b> = A * B, 64-bit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$D76C–\$D76F | <b>DIVOUT</b> integer part of A / B                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| \$D768–\$D76B | fractional part (32.32)<br>recomputed on every write to an input byte; B = 0 gives all-ones.                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

## System registers, and the SIDs

SYS registers (read-only unless noted):

|         |                                                        |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| \$00,01 | CPU clock, kHz, LE (40500)                             |
| \$02,03 | physical RAM, MB, LE (256)                             |
| \$04    | read: latch the host clock into \$05–\$0C and return 0 |
| \$05    | sec                                                    |

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$06       | min                                                                                                                                                                                |
| \$07       | hour                                                                                                                                                                               |
| \$08       | day                                                                                                                                                                                |
| \$09       | month                                                                                                                                                                              |
| \$0A,0B    | year LE                                                                                                                                                                            |
| \$0C       | weekday (0=Sun)                                                                                                                                                                    |
| \$0D,0E,0F | frames since reset, 24-bit LE (vblank count)                                                                                                                                       |
| \$10-\$1F  | version string, NUL-terminated                                                                                                                                                     |
| \$20       | ROM base page (e.g. \$A0 for a 24 KB ROM)                                                                                                                                          |
| \$F0       | write: DUMP – the host writes dumps/dump-NNN.txt (machine state, screen, PC history, keys, the shell log); read: the number of the last dump                                       |
| \$F1       | write: append a byte to the shell log (the ROM logs command lines and DUMP notes)                                                                                                  |
| \$F2       | write 1/0: automatic dump every 900 frames (15 s) on/off (on at reset on the desktop, off on the Pi; DUMP or DUMP ON also arms the per-instruction PC recorder); read: the setting |
| \$F3       | SID clock: 0 = 1 MHz (default), 1 = PAL C64 (985248 Hz), 2 = NTSC (1022730 Hz); read/write                                                                                         |

SID registers \$00-\$18 read back the last value written (a shadow; real SIDs are write-only there). \$19-\$1C come from reSID as on the chip.

## The keyboard

Keyboard: a FIFO of key-down events. Printable keys arrive as ASCII (\$20-\$7E, already shifted/dead-keyed by the host layout on the desktop); control keys as ASCII controls; everything else as \$80+ codes.

## The Tube

The Tube (\$D800): Acorn's answer, refitted. The HOST runs Richard Russell's BBC BASIC interpreter (the vendored BBCTTY console edition, tube/bbcbasic) on a pty; the machine talks to it byte-wise:

|        |                                                         |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| \$D800 | <i>R status</i> bit0 alive, bit7 a byte waits in \$D801 |
| \$D801 | <i>R</i> next byte from the co-processor (pops)         |
| \$D802 | <i>W</i> a byte to the co-processor (its keyboard)      |

\$D803            *W* 1 start (spawn), 2 stop (kill)

The co-processor has its own flat 256 MB; PAGE/HIMEM live there, far beyond the 64 KB view. On the Pi the co-processor is the same interpreter (or RunCPM's Z80, program 3) running on core 3 (core/tube\_cp.c); an unfitted program leaves status reading 0. The console it talks to is JIM, the terminal at \$DA00 (core/term.h).

## A.2 VICKY, SHEILA and the sprites

Generated from core/vicky.h.

### VICKY

VICKY – the K4510 video chip.

Register block at IO\_VICKY (\$D000), 256 bytes, byte-addressed. Every pointer is a 28-bit physical address into main RAM; there is no video memory. Rendering is per scanline into an 8-bit indexed framebuffer the frontend supplies; the frontend applies vicky\_palette\_rgb().

\$00            **CTRL** bit0 display enable; the rest pick the mode. The glass is always 640x480 and the raster lines are always 0..479 – a smaller mode is drawn into it, doubled, and centred. bit1 columns halved (320), bit2 lines halved (240), bit3 a 200-line field (40 blank lines top and bottom), bit4 columns quartered (160; with bit1).

|          |         |       |         |
|----------|---------|-------|---------|
| 1        | 640x480 | 1 4   | 640x240 |
| 1 2      | 320x240 | 1 2 8 | 320x200 |
| 1 2 8 16 | 160x200 | 1 4 8 | 640x200 |

\$01            **BGCOL** background palette index (where nothing is drawn)

\$02            **RASTER** read: current line (low 8); write: raster-compare low

\$03            read: line high bits; write: compare high

\$04            **IRQSTAT** bit0 vblank, bit1 raster==compare, bit2 SHEILA IRQ op, bit3 sprite collision. Write 1s to acknowledge.

\$05            **IRQMASK** same bits; IRQ line = IRQSTAT & IRQMASK

\$06            **PALIDX** palette index for the write port

\$07            **PALR**

|           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$08      | <b>PALG</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| \$09      | <b>PALB</b> – writing B commits the entry and increments PALIDX                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| \$0A-\$0D | <b>SPRTAB</b> 28-bit pointer to the sprite attribute table (128 x 16 B)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| \$0E      | <b>SPRCTL</b> bit0 sprites enable                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| \$0F      | reserved                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| \$60-\$63 | <b>SHEILA</b> 28-bit pointer to SHEILA's list                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| \$64      | <b>SHEILACTL</b> bit0 enable; the list restarts every frame at line 0                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| \$70-\$73 | <b>BLTSRC</b> 28-bit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| \$74-\$77 | <b>BLTDST</b> 28-bit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| \$78,79   | <b>BLTW</b> width px                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| \$7A,7B   | <b>BLTH</b> height px                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| \$7C,7D   | <b>BLTSS</b> source stride (bytes)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| \$7E,7F   | <b>BLTDS</b> dest stride                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| \$80      | <b>BLTOP</b> 0 copy, 1 keyed copy (src 0 skipped), 2 fill (value = BLTSRC byte 0), 3 AND, 4 OR, 5 XOR,<br>6 LINE: from (LX0,LY0) to (LX1,LY1), colour = BLTSRC byte 0, into the BLTDST surface of stride BLTDS, clipped to 0..BLTW-1 x 0..BLTH-1<br>7 TRIANGLE: filled (LX0,LY0)-(LX1,LY1)-(LX2,LY2), same colour, surface and clip as LINE |
| \$81      | <b>BLTFLG</b> bit0 H-flip, bit1 V-flip                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| \$82      | <b>BLTCMD</b> write anything: go. Instant. Reads 0.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| \$84,85   | <b>LX0</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$86,87   | <b>LY0</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$88,89   | <b>LX1</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$8A,8B   | <b>LY1</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$8C,8D   | <b>LX2</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| \$8E,8F   | <b>LY2</b> (signed 16-bit)<br>Blits are 8 bpp (one byte per pixel) in this version.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| \$90-\$9F | <b>COLSS</b> read: sprite-sprite collision bits, one bit per sprite (sprite n hit another sprite this frame). Cleared on read of \$40.                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| \$A0-\$AF | <b>COLSL</b> read: sprite-layer collision bits (sprite n over a non-transparent layer pixel). Cleared on read of \$50.<br>Sprite attribute entry, 16 bytes, in main RAM:                                                                                                                                                                    |
| +0,1      | X (signed 16)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| +2,3      | Y (signed 16)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

|         |                                                                                                               |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| +4..7   | <b>DATA</b> 28-bit pointer                                                                                    |
| +8      | <b>CTRL</b> bit0 enable, bit1 8 bpp (else 4), bit2 H-flip, bit3 V-flip, bits4-5 Z: drawn after layer Z (0..3) |
| +9      | <b>SIZE</b> bits0-1 width 8/16/32/64, bits2-3 height 8/16/32/64                                               |
| +10     | <b>PALOFS</b> (4 bpp: index = PALOFS«4   pixel)                                                               |
| +11..15 | reserved                                                                                                      |

Pixel 0 is transparent. No per-line limit. 128 sprites.

**SHEILA** – the display-list coprocessor (Doc named it, 2026-08-22; the Amiga's copper is the ancestor). 4-byte instructions in main RAM, executed at the start of each scanline until a **WAIT** blocks. Register writes take effect for the line about to be drawn.

|                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00                                                                                                              | <b>END</b> stop until next frame                                                                                                                                                        |
| 01                                                                                                              | <b>WAIT</b> lo hi wait for line $\geq (hi \ll 8   lo)$                                                                                                                                  |
| 02                                                                                                              | <b>MOVE</b> reg val write val to VICKY register reg                                                                                                                                     |
| 03                                                                                                              | <b>SKIP</b> lo hi skip next instruction if line $\geq$ value                                                                                                                            |
| 04                                                                                                              | <b>JUMP</b> a0 a1 a2 continue at 24-bit address                                                                                                                                         |
| 05                                                                                                              | <b>IRQ</b> set IRQSTAT bit2                                                                                                                                                             |
| At most 256 instructions per line are executed (runaway guard).<br>Layers 0..3 at \$10 + n*\$10, 16 bytes each: |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| +0                                                                                                              | <b>LCTRL</b> bit0 enable, bits1-2 mode (0 bitmap, 1 tile, 2 text8, 3 text32), bits3-4 bpp (0=1, 1=2, 2=4, 3=8), bits5-6 cell size (tile: 8/16/32/64 px square; text: 0 = 8x8, 1 = 8x16) |
| +1                                                                                                              | <b>LPALOFS</b> palette offset for <8 bpp: index = (value « depth)   pixel                                                                                                               |
| +2,3                                                                                                            | <b>SCROLLX</b> 16-bit, pixels                                                                                                                                                           |
| +4,5                                                                                                            | <b>SCROLLY</b> 16-bit, pixels                                                                                                                                                           |
| +6,7                                                                                                            | <b>STRIDE</b> bitmap: bytes per row. tile/text: map entries per row.                                                                                                                    |
| +8..+B                                                                                                          | <b>DATA</b> 28-bit pointer: pixels (bitmap) or glyph/tile set                                                                                                                           |
| +C..+F                                                                                                          | <b>MAP</b> 28-bit pointer: the map                                                                                                                                                      |

Map formats:

|        |                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| tile   | 2 bytes/cell: bits 0-9 tile index, 10 H-flip, 11 V-flip, 12-15 palette offset (used for <8 bpp). Tile pixel data at DATA + index * (size*size*bpp/8), rows MSB-first packed. |
| text8  | 1 byte/cell: glyph index. 1 bpp 8xH glyphs at DATA + g*H. Colours from LPALOFS: index = (LPALOFS«1)   pixel.                                                                 |
| text32 | 4 bytes/cell: glyph lo, glyph hi (16-bit index), fg, bg – byte-wide palette indices per cell. bit7 of glyph hi = reverse.                                                    |

Layer 0 is bottom. Pixel index 0 is transparent in every layer; BGCOL is the ground (text32 bg is never transparent). Changed 2026-08-22 from “opaque in the lowest layer” so SHEILA backgrounds show under text.

## A.3 The network

Generated from core/net.h.

### The N: device

The network, three ways – each borrowed from the machine that did it first.

The Meatloaf rule (the C64’s Meatloaf cartridge): a URL is a file name. A name beginning `http://`, `https://` or `tnfs://` that reaches the filesystem device (\$D300) for reading – LOAD, TYPE, CP, RUN, EhBASIC’s LOAD, BBC BASIC’s LOAD on the Tube – is fetched and served like a file. No ROM change: the ROM passes names through untouched and the host fetches.

TNFS (the Spectranet’s file protocol, the one FujiNet and Meatloaf servers speak; UDP, port 16384): a `tnfs://host[:port]/path` is also a DIRECTORY. `CD tnfs://host/path` puts the machine’s current directory on the server: `DIR` lists it, a bare name loads from it (so the REXX rule runs programs off the internet), `CD ..` climbs it, `CD -` comes home. The server is read-only from here.

The N: device (FujiNet’s network device, as the Atari and Apple saw it), at \$D900, for programs that want a live connection: four channels, each a URL opened for reading and writing.

|               |                                                                                                                                |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$D900        | <i>W</i> command                                                                                                               |
| \$D901        | <i>R</i> status (0 ok, 1 not found / refused, 2 i/o error, 3 bad command, 4 closed by the peer, 5 name too long, 6 not fitted) |
| \$D902        | <i>RW</i> channel 0-3                                                                                                          |
| \$D904-\$D907 | <b>NAMEPTR</b> 28-bit -> URL, NUL-terminated                                                                                   |
| \$D908-\$D90B | <b>ADDR</b> 28-bit                                                                                                             |
| \$D90C-\$D90F | <b>LEN</b> bytes requested; updated to bytes done                                                                              |
| \$D910-\$D913 | <b>SIZE</b> after OPEN: the content length, \$FFFFFFF if unknown; after STATUS: bytes waiting                                  |

commands: 1 OPEN (`tcp://host:port` a connection; `http://`, `https://`, `tnfs://` a file, fetched whole, then READ)

2 READ (up to LEN bytes to ADDR, what has arrived so far; LEN = done, 0 = nothing yet)

- 3 WRITE (LEN bytes from ADDR; tcp only)
- 4 CLOSE
- 5 STATUS (SIZE = bytes waiting; status 4 once the peer has closed and the bytes are gone)
- 6 GET (the Meatloaf rule for programs: fetch the whole URL into ADDR, at most LEN; LEN = done, SIZE = total)

Reads never block the machine: a program polls, as it would a UART. Underneath: core/net\_plat.h – sockets and curl on the desktop, Circle's stack on the Pi (no TLS there: https answers 6).

## A.4 JIM, the terminal

Generated from core/term.h.

### JIM

JIM, the terminal (\$DA00) – the Beeb's third page, given a job: a VT100 with the ANSI colour and VT220 editing additions, in hardware – the way a real 8-bit machine got a serious terminal: a card, not a program. It draws on the VICKY text32 screen the ROM console uses, inside the geometry the ROM gives it, so the console and the terminal share one screen and one cursor. Anything that needs a terminal writes its byte stream here: the ROM for the Tube (CP/M programs set up for VT100/ANSI, BBC BASIC's console edition) and TELNET for the BBSes (ANSI-BBS: CP437 glyphs, 16 colours).

- \$DA00      **W DATA** a byte of the stream
- \$DA01      **R STATUS** bit7 a reply byte waits; bit0 the stream moved the cursor since CX/CY were written
- \$DA02      **R REPLY** the next reply byte (pops): answers to ESC[6n / ESC[c, and translated keys
- \$DA03      **W KEY** a K4510 key code (io.h): its terminal bytes go to REPLY (arrows ESC[A.. or ESC OA.. in application mode, Home/End, PgUp/PgDn/Ins ESC[n~, Del \$7F, F1-F4 ESC OP., F5-F12 ESC[15~.., everything else through unchanged)
- \$DA04      **W CTRL** 1 reset (modes, attributes, cursor home; the screen kept)  
2 clear the screen and home
- \$DA05-\$DA0D      **RW COLS ROWS OX OY CX CY FG BG STRIDE** the window: origin (OX,OY) cells, STRIDE cells per row



**\$DA0E** *RW* **FLAGS** bit0 cursor shown (blinking) bit1 read: application cursor keys (DECCKM)

**\$DA10-\$DA13** *RW* **BASE** 28-bit address of the text32 map (reset: \$030000)

**\$DA14,\$DA15** *RW* **DEFFG DEFBG** the colours SGR 0 / 39 / 49 return to

Sequences: the VT100 set (cursor, ED/EL, DECSTBM, DECSC/DECRC, IND/RI/NEL, tabs, DECAWM/DECOM/DECCKM, DEC line drawing via ESC(0 and SO/SI, DSR, DA, DECALN, RIS), ANSI SGR 0/1/4/5/7/22/24/27/30-37/39/40-47/49/90-97/100-107 and 38;5;n / 48;5;n for n < 16, VT220 ICH/DCH/IL/DL/ECH/SU/SD/CHA/VPA, IRM, ESC[?25 cursor, ESC[s/u, DECSTR. Bytes \$80-\$FF are glyphs (CP437).

## A.5 Memory and the far view

Generated from core/mem.h.

### The ROM window and the stub page

The ROM image lives in the top 64 KB of physical memory and is seen in the unmapped CPU view from mem\_rom\_base up; the physical RAM at \$A000-\$FFFF is “RAM under the ROM”, revealed by banking blocks 5/7 onto \$A000/\$E000 (K-05). The page \$FF00-\$FFFF always reads the ROM, whatever is banked: the system-call stub and the vectors live there.

# Filing an Issue

This machine has one author, and an issue you file here will, in all likelihood, be handed straight to an AI coding session to work on. That is worth knowing before you write one, because it changes what a good report looks like.

So the form below is not really a form. It is a prompt. Filled in, it carries enough for the work to start without a single question coming back to you; left as prose, it usually costs one exchange to establish things you already knew when you typed it.

## Three things first

None of these is politeness. Each one removes a day.

**Type DUMP while it is wrong.** The machine writes its whole state — registers, the screen as you are looking at it, the last 4096 instructions, your last keystrokes, and the log of every command you have typed — to `dumps/dump-NNN.txt` on the host. It is written for exactly this purpose. If you can manage only one line of the report, make it the dump: it is worth more than any description either of us could write.

**Try it again with k4510 --no-startup.bat.** A `/STARTUP.BAT` that has gone wrong looks exactly like a machine that has gone wrong, and it has cost this project a diagnosis more than once. Ten seconds of your time settles it.

**Look it up in this book.** If the machine disagrees with a page here, that is still a fault worth filing — it is simply this book's fault rather than the machine's, and it gets fixed the same way. Say which page, and the two halves of the project can sort out between them which one was lying.

## The report

Copy this, fill in what you can, delete what does not apply. Nothing in it is required except the last two lines.

```
Machine: BMC-K4510, desktop | Raspberry Pi 3B+
Version: from this book's cover, or the release you downloaded
        (INFO -v names the K/OS and emulator generation, coarser)
Where:   shell | EhBASIC | BBC BASIC | CP/M | Forth | Pascal |
        VI or EDIT | the F7 menu | this handbook
```

What I typed, exactly:

```
LOAD "DEMO.BAS"
RUN
```

What happened:

What I expected:

Why I expected it: handbook p.NN | a real C64 or Beeb does it |  
it worked before

Still wrong with k4510 --no-startup.bat ? yes | no | did not try  
Dump: dumps/dump-017.txt (type DUMP, then attach that file)

## Why those lines and not others

**What I typed, exactly.** Not a summary of what you did — the lines themselves, as they went in. The machine is deterministic and its figures in this book are captured by replaying keystrokes into it, so a transcript can be run again as written. A paraphrase cannot.

**Why I expected it.** This is the line that most reports leave out and most exchanges are then spent on. The K4510 is a fantasy machine (page 55): there is no silicon anywhere that it can be measured against, so “wrong” only means anything next to what you were expecting and where you got that from. It is also what separates a bug from a design decision from an error in this book — three different repairs, and the answer decides which one starts.

**Where.** The machine is several machines: a shell, two BASICs, a Z80 under CP/M, a Forth, a Pascal, two editors and a book. Naming yours is

what routes the report.

## Where it goes

<https://github.com/mlongval/bmc-k4510/issues>

The same block appears there as the repository's issue template, generated from this page so that the two cannot drift apart. If you have no account there, the same text in an email is worth exactly as much.

Feature requests and disagreements are welcome in the same shape — “what I expected” does the work whether or not anything is broken.

**One thing to check before you attach a dump.** It carries the shell log, which is every command line you typed in that session, and file names from your own disk along with them. It is a plain text file: open it and have a look before it goes anywhere public.

# Disclaimer

The BMC-K4510 is a hobby project: a computer that does not exist, built for the pleasure of building it. It is offered to you as a gift, and it comes with exactly the guarantees a gift comes with — none.

In the words of the licence it is distributed under (page 61), and meaning every one of them:

**THERE IS NO WARRANTY FOR THE PROGRAM, TO THE EXTENT PERMITTED BY APPLICABLE LAW.** EXCEPT WHEN OTHERWISE STATED IN WRITING THE COPYRIGHT HOLDERS AND/OR OTHER PARTIES PROVIDE THE PROGRAM “AS IS” WITHOUT WARRANTY OF ANY KIND, EITHER EXPRESSED OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO, THE IMPLIED WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY AND FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE. THE ENTIRE RISK AS TO THE QUALITY AND PERFORMANCE OF THE PROGRAM IS WITH YOU. SHOULD THE PROGRAM PROVE DEFECTIVE, YOU ASSUME THE COST OF ALL NECESSARY SERVICING, REPAIR OR CORRECTION.

**IN NO EVENT** WILL ANY COPYRIGHT HOLDER, OR ANY OTHER PARTY WHO MAY MODIFY AND/OR REDISTRIBUTE THE PROGRAM AS PERMITTED ABOVE, BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR DAMAGES, INCLUDING ANY GENERAL, SPECIAL, INCIDENTAL OR CONSEQUENTIAL DAMAGES ARISING OUT OF THE USE OR INABILITY TO USE THE PROGRAM.

In plainer words: nobody promises this machine works, that it will keep working, or that anything it writes to your disk is safe. Keep backups. Do not fly aeroplanes with it, run hospitals on it, or trust it with money. It is a toy, and it is allowed to be wrong.

The same goes for this book: where it and the machine disagree, the machine is right. Nothing here is endorsed by or affiliated with Acorn, Commodore, Microsoft, Digital Research, the MEGA65 project, the Raspberry Pi Foundation, or anyone else gratefully named in these pages. The mistakes are the author’s alone.

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**Constructive comments can be left at the repository's issues page:**

<https://github.com/mlongval/bmc-k4510/issues>

**All complaints, criticisms and negativity can be addressed to**  
`/dev/null`

---

# Thank You

The BMC-K4510 is a machine that never existed. Almost everything in it that *does* exist was written by somebody else first, and given away. This chapter is the thanks; the Licences chapter (page 61) is the paperwork.

## The heart of the machine

**Gábor Lénárt** (LGB) wrote the 45GS02 CPU core in Xemu, the MEGA65 emulator. It runs here unchanged — not a line altered, not a bug fixed — and every instruction this book describes is his code executing. There would be no K4510 without it.

**Dag Lem** wrote reSID, the SID emulation that has been the reference for thirty years. The K4510's four sound chips are four copies of it (the 6581 model, as shipped in VICE 3.3).

**The VICE team**, whose decades of emulation scholarship — documentation, test programs, arguments settled in code — this project consulted at nearly every turn.

## The tongues

**Lee Davison** (1966–2013) wrote EhBASIC, the machine's first BASIC and still the one that comes up in ROM. He is not here to be asked about the graphics and sound words bolted onto it; the machine carries his name in its README and its startup banner instead.

**Richard T. Russell** wrote BBC BASIC, and has kept writing it for forty years. The console edition (BBCTTY) is what runs on the Tube co-processor in Chapter 4. The name “BBC BASIC” is used here *by his permission*, which is a courtesy this project does not take lightly.

**Marcelo Dantas** (“Mockba the Borg”) wrote RunCPM, which is the whole of Chapter 6: a complete CP/M 2.2 with its own CCP, vendored here unmodified and simply handed a Z80’s worth of address space.

**Scot W. Stevenson**, **Sam Colwell** and **Patrick Surry** wrote Tali Forth 2 and put it in the public domain — a Forth written to be read, which is why Chapter 5 can be honest about how it works.

**Tomasz Biela** (“tebe”) wrote Mad Pascal and MADS; the K4510 target in pascal/ is a guest in his compiler. **Wojciech Bociański** (“bocianu”), whose Neo6502 target showed how such a guest should behave.

**Steve Wozniak** wrote Wozmon in 1976 in 256 bytes, and the monitor in this machine is still recognisably it.

**Michael Steil** maintains msbasic, and **Microsoft** released 6502 BASIC 1.1 under the MIT licence in 2025 — between them, the machine’s next native BASIC.

## Letters on the screen

Fonts are the part of a computer you look at longest, and clean ones with a clear pedigree are hard to come by.

**The Linux kernel** contributors — the 8x8 console font (font\_8x8.c) that got the text mode on its feet and is still the default.

**Paul Gardner-Stephen** and **Roman Standzikowski** (FeralChild64) — the clean-room C64/C65 chargen from MEGA65 open-roms, and **Retrofan**, whose PXLfont travels with it by permission.

**Ville-Matias Heikkilä** (“Viznut”) — unscii, placed in the public domain.

**Damian Vila** — BESCII, the PETSCII spirit with a clean pedigree, CC0.

## The bare metal

**Randy Rossi** wrote BMC64: VICE on a Raspberry Pi with no operating system under it, 50 Hz smooth scrolling and input latency measured in single frames. It is the direct reason this machine has a Pi port at all



— the route to the Pi was always meant to be BMC64's `emux_api` seam, and the bare-metal case it proved is what made the port thinkable. He also built the **VIC-II Kawari**, a modern drop-in VIC-II with video modes the original never had: the demonstration that you may extend an 8-bit machine's video chip and still be working inside the tradition rather than outside it. VICKY is a more reckless cousin of that idea. **minch** (aminch) has taken BMC64 over from him and carries it onto the newer Pis; the project is in good hands.

**Rene Stange** wrote Circle, the bare-metal C++ environment that is the entire reason a Raspberry Pi 3B+ can boot straight into this machine with no operating system under it. **Xalior** wrote circle-libsdl2, which let the desktop emulator move to the Pi essentially as written.

## The workshop

The machine is built with **cc65** (compiler, assembler, linker and runtime for the whole system ROM), **64tass**, **NASM**, **GCC** and **GNU Make**; it shows itself to you through **SDL2**. This book is set in **XeLaTeX** with **Clear Sans** and **Iosevka**, and every screenshot in it was captured from the machine actually running — a picture that cannot be produced fails the build.

## Heritage

Some debts are not code.

**Acorn Computers** — the Tube, the sideways-ROM model, the `*` command prefix, and the idea that a second processor should be a normal thing to own. The Beeb's ghost is all over this machine.

**Commodore** — the other half of its soul: PETSCII, the SID, and the line from the PET to the C65 that stopped one machine short of this one.

**The MEGA65 project** — for keeping the 45GS02 and the C65 dream alive in real silicon, and for open-roms.

**Kim Lemon** and the Lemoners — Lemon64 has been the C64's front door since 1998: the games database, the reviews and scans, the music, and a forum that actually answers. Twenty-eight years of one person's dedication to a machine's community, and a good half of the small facts this project needed came from there.

**Paul Scott Robson** wrote the Neo6502's firmware — the operating system and BASIC that make an Olimex Neo6502 a computer rather than a board — and the handbook that documents it. That book is the one this one is modelled on, down to the page size, and the rule that every example must be run and photographed before it may be printed is his. The other model is the **MEGA65 User's Guide**.

**The High Voltage SID Collection** and the composers in it, whose tunes are what SIDPLAY plays on a good evening. None of that music is distributed with this machine (see the Licences chapter); it is theirs.

**And the machine's other author.** Most of the K4510's own code — VICKY, SHEILA, the DMA engine, the ROM, K/OS, the Tube ULA, the editors, the Pi port — was written in conversation with Claude (Anthropic's Claude Code), over several months of long sessions with a build log to prove it. The design decisions are the author's; a great deal of the typing was not.

## And whoever is missing

This list was assembled by hand and is certainly incomplete. If your work is in this machine and your name is not on this page, that is an error and not a judgement — open an issue at <https://github.com/mlongval/bmc-k4510> and it will be fixed in the next printing.

# Licences

The Thank You chapter (page 57) is the thanks; this is the record. The authoritative copy is `LICENSES.md` in the repository — if the two ever disagree, that file wins.

## The project itself

The BMC-K4510 as a whole is distributed under the **GNU General Public License, version 2 or (at your option) any later version**. Everything written for this project — the machine, VICKY, SHEILA, the DMA engine, the MATH unit, the system ROM and K/OS, JIM, the Tube ULA, the network layer, the editors, the demos, the Pascal target and the Raspberry Pi port — is Copyright © 2026 Michael Longval and is released under those terms. The choice is not really a choice: the CPU core and reSID are GPL-2.0-or-later, and a work containing them must be too.

## Code inside the machine

- **Xemu 65xx/45GS02 CPU core** — Gábor Lénárt. `core/xemu/`: `cpu65.c`, `cpu65.h`, `cpu65_mega65_timings.h`, `cpu65ce02_disasm_tables.c`, used unchanged. *GPL-2.0-or-later*.
- **reSID** — Dag Lem, as shipped in VICE 3.3. `core/resid/`. *GPL-2.0-or-later*.
- **BBC BASIC, console edition (BBCTTY)** — Richard T. Russell. `tube/`, vendored and altered (see `tube/ALTERED.md`). *zlib licence*. The name “BBC BASIC” is used by permission; that permission is personal to this project and is *not* transferable to forks or derivatives.
- **EhBASIC 2.22** — Lee Davison, in the ca65 form from `jefftranter/6502.basic/basic.asm`. *Free for non-commercial use only*; derivatives must carry the words “Derived from EhBASIC” — see `basic/`

README-EhBASIC.txt. It ships as a separate program (fs/ehbasic.prg) and is not linked with the GPL code.

- **RunCPM** — Marcelo Dantas. cpm/src/, vendored unmodified (cpm/VENDORED-FROM.txt). *MIT*.
- **Tali Forth 2** — Scot W. Stevenson, Sam Colwell, Patrick Surry. forth/tali/, vendored unmodified. *Public domain*.
- **Wozmon** — Steve Wozniak’s 1976 monitor, reimplemented here for the 45GS10. Apple published the original listing; this machine’s version is the project’s own code under the project licence.
- **cc65 runtime** — the ROM and every .prg are linked against none.lib. cc65’s *zlib-style licence*.
- **Microsoft 6502 BASIC 1.1** (planned, via mist64/msbasic) — *MIT*, released by Microsoft in 2025. Not yet in the machine.

## Fonts

- **Linux kernel 8x8 console font** — data/font8.bin, built by data/mkfont.py from lib/fonts/font\_8x8.c. *GPL-2.0*. This is the default text font.
- **MEGA65 open-roms chargen + PXLfont 2.3** — data/fonts/openroms/. Clean-room C64/C65 character shapes; PXLfont is Retrofan’s, included with open-roms’ recorded permission. *LGPL-3.0-or-later* — 8x8font.png is shipped as the editable source, for LGPL compliance.
- **unscii-8** — Ville-Matias Heikkilä. data/fonts/unscii/; font8-unscii.bin is a generated drop-in alternative to data/font8.bin. *Public domain*.
- **BESCIi v3** (Mono + source) — Damian Vila. data/fonts/bescii/. *CC0-1.0*.
- **Clear Sans** (Intel, *Apache-2.0*) and **Iosevka** (Belleve Invis, *SIL OFL 1.1*) — the two faces this book is set in. They are not part of the machine.

**No Commodore ROMs here.** Until 2026-08-23 the text font was derived from a Commodore 64 character ROM. That file and every derivative were removed from the repository *and from its history* before it was made public. If you own a C64 and want the real thing, drop your own `chargen.bin` into `/SYSTEM:` the machine will use it, and `.gitignore` will keep it out of the repository. That copy is yours, not ours to publish.

## The Raspberry Pi build

Neither of these lives in the repository; `pi/Makefile` expects them beside the checkout.

- **Circle** — Rene Stange. *GPL-3.0*.
- **circle-libsdl2** — Xalior. *zlib*; its `sdl-app.ld` is *GPL-3.0*.

A `kernel8.img` built from these is therefore *GPL-3.0* as a whole, which *GPL-2.0-or-later* code permits. The Raspberry Pi boot firmware in a distributed card image (`bootcode.bin`, `start.elf`, `fixup.dat`) is Broadcom's, redistributable with Raspberry Pi hardware under its own licence.

## Build tools

Not distributed with the machine, but required to build it: GCC and GNU Make (*GPL*), `cc65` (*zlib-style*), `64tass` (*GPL-2.0*), NASM (*BSD-2-Clause*), `SDL2` (*zlib*), Python 3 (*PSF*), and for this book XeLaTeX (*LPPL*). Mad Pascal and MADS (Tomasz Biela, *MIT*) are needed only if you compile Pascal; the `K4510` target in `pascal/` is installed into your own Mad Pascal checkout.

## What is deliberately not shipped

- **The CP/M system disk.** `RunCPM's DISK/A0.zip` — Digital Research's ASM, MAC, DDT, STAT, SUBMIT and third-party tools — installs into `fs/CPM/`

A/0/ for your use but is not committed: its files have mixed provenance and this repository is public. The same goes for WordStar, Turbo Pascal 3 and MBASIC, which the K-\*.SUB launchers know how to start but which you must supply yourself.

- **SID tunes.** fs/SID is a symbolic link to a local copy of the High Voltage SID Collection. The tunes are the composers' copyright, are used here only for listening, and are not part of this repository or of any release.
- **A Commodore character ROM** — see the note above.
- **Your STARTUP.BAT** — yours, not the repository's (copy /SYSTEM/STARTUP.SAMPLE to start one).

## If you redistribute the machine

Ship the sources you built from, keep LICENSES.md and this chapter with them, keep 8x8font.png beside the open-roms font, and remember two things that are easy to forget: EhBASIC is non-commercial-only, and the “BBC BASIC” name is licensed to this project and not to yours. Call your fork's BASIC something else.